Sola Scriptura

Topical Bible Study Series

Module 2

Robert Coleridge

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Dedication

I dedicate this book first and foremost to Jesus Christ, the "main thing," who alone provides the only way to Heaven through His sacrifice at Calvary, offering the free gift of salvation to all who accept it. I am deeply grateful to my wife, Terry, who patiently endures my daily question, "What does the Bible say about that?" To my parents, siblings, and children, thank you for the invaluable lessons you've taught me about living out the faith. I also want to thank my fellow believers in Christ who gently corrected me when I was wrong and helped me grow in truth and love. I'm especially appreciative of my brothers and sisters in Christ at our local church who continually help me keep the main thing, the main thing—thank you, Jeff, for that reminder. I'm thankful for the godly pastors, professors, and preachers from whom I've learned so much over the years. A special thanks goes to Pastor Schad and his wonderful wife, Lisa, of NCF, for faithfully following the leading of the Holy Spirit for the glory of God the Father, under the lordship of God the Son. Each of you has played a meaningful role in shaping this journey, and I thank God for you all.

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Preface

In an age of moral confusion and shifting truths, the unchanging authority of God's Word stands as a beacon for those who seek clarity, purpose, and hope. *Sola Scriptura*—"Scripture Alone"—is more than a doctrine; it is a call to return to the source of truth, to let the Bible shape not only our beliefs, but our daily lives.

This volume marks the second module of a multi-part series designed to explore the Christian life through the lens of Scripture. Each module is carefully curated to build upon the last, offering readers a deeper understanding of faith, doctrine, and practical living. In this installment—Module 2: we continue to examine what it means to walk with Christ, live by the Spirit, and embrace our identity as God's people.

With over 60 topical studies, this book covers foundational themes such as the Word of God, discipleship, holiness, stewardship, community, spiritual growth, and prayer. Each topic includes key Scriptures, sound teaching, personal reflection questions, and life applications making it ideal for personal devotions, group studies, or sermon preparation.

Future modules will be released as separate volumes, diving deeper into topics such as doctrinal discernment, spiritual warfare, emotional healing, cultural engagement, and the hope of eternity. Together, these modules will provide a comprehensive discipleship path rooted entirely in the Bible useful for individual studies or group studies. I have found in group studies that having each person do the study before meeting and then discussing their responses, reactions, and applications to be very helpful.

My hope is that this work inspires you not just to study Scripture, but to live it. May it awaken a deeper hunger for God's truth, ignite transformation, and equip you to stand firm in faith with grace and conviction.

For the glory of God alone,

Robert Coleridge
May 2025

Sola Scriptura 2:1
The Sovereignty of God in Trials

FOCUS: TRUSTING IN GOD'S CONTROL AND PURPOSES DURING DIFFICULT SEASONS OF LIFE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 8:28
- Job 1:21
- Isaiah 55:8-9

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- James 1:2-4
- 2 Corinthians 4:16-18
- Genesis 50:20
- Psalm 46:10

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's sovereignty assures believers that He is in control, even in trials, using them for His glory and our growth (Romans 8:28, Genesis 50:20).
- Trials are not random but serve a refining purpose, deepening faith and producing spiritual maturity (James 1:2-4, Isaiah 55:8-9).
- Trusting in God's sovereignty provides peace and hope, knowing His plans are higher and ultimately good (2 Corinthians 4:16-18, Psalm 46:10).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does Romans 8:28 provide comfort during trials?**
   - It assures believers that God is working all circumstances for their ultimate good and His glory.
2. **What can we learn from Job's response to suffering (Job 1:21)?**
   - Job acknowledges God's sovereignty, choosing to praise Him even in loss and confusion.
3. **How can trials lead to spiritual maturity (James 1:2-4)?**
   - Trials develop perseverance, refining faith and character to make believers more Christlike.
4. **What does it mean to trust God's higher ways (Isaiah 55:8-9)?**
   - It means surrendering our understanding and resting in God's perfect wisdom and plans.
5. **How can you focus on God's sovereignty in your own trials?**
   - By meditating on His promises, seeking His presence in prayer, and trusting His purpose in difficulties (Psalm 46:10).

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on God's Sovereignty**: Write down examples of how God has used past trials for good in your life.
2. **Trust in Trials**: Choose a current struggle and surrender it to God in prayer, trusting His control.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share with someone how God's sovereignty has sustained you in difficult times.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Praise God for His control and faithfulness in every season of life.
2. Pray for trust in His purposes during trials.
3. Ask for strength and wisdom to glorify Him in difficulties.

Sola Scriptura 2:2

The Fruit of the Spirit in Daily Life

FOCUS: LIVING OUT THE CHARACTERISTICS OF THE FRUIT OF THE SPIRIT IN PRACTICAL, EVERYDAY WAYS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 5:22-23
- John 15:5
- Matthew 7:16-20

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 4:2-3
- Colossians 3:12-14
- Philippians 4:4-7
- James 3:17-18

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- The Fruit of the Spirit reflects Christlike character produced by the Holy Spirit in a believer's life (Galatians 5:22-23, John 15:5).
- These qualities grow as believers remain connected to Christ, allowing His Spirit to transform their actions and attitudes (Matthew 7:16-20, Colossians 3:12-14).
- Living out the Fruit daily impacts relationships, witnesses to God's work, and brings peace and joy (Philippians 4:4-7, James 3:17-18).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to bear the Fruit of the Spirit (Galatians 5:22-23)?**
   - It means displaying Christlike qualities that reflect the Spirit's work in your life.
2. **How does abiding in Christ help you bear fruit (John 15:5)?**
   - Remaining in Christ through prayer, Scripture, and obedience allows His life to flow through us.
3. **How can the Fruit of the Spirit impact your relationships?**
   - It fosters forgiveness, compassion, and unity, reflecting God's love to others (Ephesians 4:2-3).
4. **Which aspect of the Fruit do you find most challenging, and how can you grow in it?**
   - Answers will vary; growth requires prayer, intentional practice, and reliance on the Spirit.
5. **How can living out the Fruit of the Spirit be a witness to others?**
   - It demonstrates the transforming power of Christ, drawing others to Him (Matthew 5:16).

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Focus on One Fruit**: Choose one aspect of the Fruit of the Spirit to intentionally practice this week.
2. **Evaluate Your Walk**: Reflect on which qualities are strongest and which need growth in your life.
3. **Show Christlike Character**: Identify a relationship where you can apply patience, kindness, or gentleness.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the Spirit's work in producing fruit in your life.
2. Pray for growth in a specific area of the Fruit of the Spirit.
3. Ask for opportunities to demonstrate Christlike character to others.

Sola Scriptura 2:3

The Role of Community in Faith

FOCUS: EMBRACING THE VALUE OF FELLOWSHIP AND MUTUAL SUPPORT WITHIN THE BODY OF CHRIST.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 10:24-25
- Acts 2:42-47
- Ecclesiastes 4:9-10

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Corinthians 12:12-27
- Galatians 6:2
- Ephesians 4:11-16
- Proverbs 27:17

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Community is essential for spiritual growth, encouragement, and accountability, reflecting God's design for the Church (Hebrews 10:24-25, Acts 2:42).
- Believers are called to support and build one another up, fostering unity and love (Galatians 6:2, 1 Corinthians 12:12-27).
- Fellowship provides strength in times of weakness and opportunities to serve and glorify God together (Ecclesiastes 4:9-10, Ephesians 4:11-16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why is meeting together important for faith (Hebrews 10:24-25)?**
   - It provides encouragement, accountability, and mutual growth in love and good deeds.

2. **What can we learn from the early Church's community (Acts 2:42-47)?**
   - They prioritized fellowship, prayer, generosity, and unity, resulting in spiritual growth and outreach.
3. **How does being part of the Body of Christ impact individual faith (1 Corinthians 12:12-27)?**
   - Each believer has a unique role, and together, they function as Christ's hands and feet on earth.
4. **How can you carry someone's burden (Galatians 6:2)?**
   - By offering prayer, encouragement, practical help, or simply being present in their time of need.
5. **What does Proverbs 27:17 teach about accountability in community?**
   - Relationships within the Church sharpen and strengthen faith, promoting spiritual growth and maturity.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Engage in Fellowship**: Join or recommit to a small group or ministry team in your church.
2. **Support Someone**: Identify someone in your community who needs encouragement and reach out to them.
3. **Serve Together**: Find a way to serve others alongside your church community.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of fellowship and the Body of Christ.
2. Pray for unity and love in your church community.
3. Ask for opportunities to support and encourage others in their faith.

Sola Scriptura 2:4

God's Promises in Scripture

FOCUS: TRUSTING IN THE FAITHFULNESS OF GOD'S PROMISES AND HOW THEY SUSTAIN BELIEVERS IN EVERY SEASON OF LIFE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Peter 1:4
- Joshua 23:14
- Hebrews 10:23

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Jeremiah 29:11
- Isaiah 41:10
- Philippians 4:19
- Romans 8:38-39

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's promises are rooted in His unchanging character, offering hope, assurance, and direction for life (2 Peter 1:4, Hebrews 10:23).
- These promises include provision, protection, guidance, and eternal life, fulfilled in Jesus Christ (Joshua 23:14, Isaiah 41:10).
- Trusting in God's promises strengthens faith and enables believers to face challenges with confidence (Philippians 4:19, Romans 8:38-39).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 2 Peter 1:4 teach about God's promises?**
    - They are precious and enable believers to participate in God's divine nature and escape worldly corruption.

2. **How does God's faithfulness ensure the fulfillment of His promises (Hebrews 10:23)?**
    - His unchanging character and sovereignty guarantee that He will fulfill all He has said.
3. **What does Jeremiah 29:11 reveal about God's intentions for His people?**
    - It assures believers of His plans to prosper them, give them hope, and secure their future.
4. **How can believers rely on God's promises in difficult times (Isaiah 41:10)?**
    - By trusting in His presence, strength, and assurance of help, even in moments of fear or uncertainty.
5. **What practical steps can you take to internalize God's promises?**
    - Meditate on Scripture, memorize key verses, and apply His promises to specific life circumstances.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Claim a Promise**: Choose one of God's promises to memorize and meditate on this week.
2. **Trust in God's Word**: Reflect on a past situation where God fulfilled a promise in your life.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share a specific promise of God with someone who needs encouragement.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His faithfulness in fulfilling His promises.
2. Pray for trust and confidence in His Word.
3. Ask for clarity and strength to live in light of His promises.

Sola Scriptura 2:5
The Call to Holiness

FOCUS: PURSUING A LIFE THAT REFLECTS GOD'S CHARACTER AND SET-APARTNESS FOR HIS PURPOSES.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Peter 1:15-16
- Leviticus 20:26
- Hebrews 12:14

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 12:1-2
- 2 Corinthians 7:1
- 1 Thessalonians 4:3-7
- Matthew 5:48

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Holiness is being set apart for God, reflecting His purity, righteousness, and love in all aspects of life (1 Peter 1:15-16, Leviticus 20:26).
- It involves living intentionally, avoiding sin, and aligning every thought and action with God's will (Hebrews 12:14, Romans 12:1-2).
- Holiness is not achieved by human effort but through the transforming work of the Holy Spirit (2 Corinthians 7:1, 1 Thessalonians 4:7).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to be holy as God is holy (1 Peter 1:15-16)?**
   - It means living a life that reflects God's character, marked by purity, love, and obedience.
2. **Why is holiness essential for believers (Hebrews 12:14)?**
   - It is necessary for seeing and experiencing deeper fellowship with God.
3. **How can believers pursue holiness daily (Romans 12:1-2)?**
   - By offering themselves to God, renewing their minds with Scripture, and resisting worldly patterns.
4. **What role does the Holy Spirit play in sanctification?**
   - The Spirit empowers believers to grow in Christlikeness, convicting them of sin and enabling them to obey God's will (Galatians 5:16-18).
5. **What practical steps can you take to grow in holiness?**
   - Practice spiritual disciplines, avoid compromising situations, and seek accountability in your faith journey.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Identify an Area for Growth**: Reflect on one area where you need to grow in holiness and make a plan for change.
2. **Renew Your Mind**: Spend focused time meditating on Scriptures that call for holiness.
3. **Seek Accountability**: Share your desire for holiness with a trusted friend and ask for their prayers and support.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Praise God for His holiness and the privilege of reflecting it in your life.

2. Pray for the Spirit's help in pursuing holiness in specific areas of your life.
3. Ask for wisdom and strength to resist sin and live set apart for God.

Sola Scriptura 2:6
Trusting God's Timing

FOCUS: FINDING PEACE AND PATIENCE IN WAITING ON GOD'S PERFECT PLANS AND PURPOSES.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Ecclesiastes 3:1-11
- Psalm 27:14
- Habakkuk 2:3

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Isaiah 40:31
- Lamentations 3:25-26
- Galatians 6:9
- Romans 8:25

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's timing is perfect, even when it doesn't align with our expectations. His plans unfold for His glory and our good (Ecclesiastes 3:11, Habakkuk 2:3).
- Waiting on the Lord builds faith, patience, and reliance on His strength and wisdom (Psalm 27:14, Isaiah 40:31).
- Trusting God's timing requires surrender and a focus on His promises, knowing that His delays are not denials (Lamentations 3:25-26, Romans 8:25).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does Ecclesiastes 3:11 describe God's timing?**
   - God makes everything beautiful and purposeful according to His plan, even if it's not immediately clear.
2. **Why is waiting on the Lord important (Psalm 27:14)?**
   - It teaches trust, strengthens faith, and aligns us with God's perfect will.
3. **What does Habakkuk 2:3 reveal about trusting God's plans?**
   - God's promises will be fulfilled at the right time, even if they seem delayed.
4. **How can you remain patient during seasons of waiting (Romans 8:25)?**
   - By focusing on God's faithfulness, staying in prayer, and relying on the hope of His promises.
5. **What practical steps can you take to trust God's timing?**
   - Journal your prayers, focus on Scriptures about waiting, and seek encouragement from trusted believers.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on God's Faithfulness**: Recall times when waiting on God's timing brought about His best plan.
2. **Practice Patience**: Choose one area of your life where you need to wait on God and surrender it in prayer.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share with someone how you've experienced God's perfect timing in your life.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His wisdom and perfect timing.
2. Pray for patience and trust in areas where waiting is challenging.
3. Ask for peace and hope as you wait for His promises to be fulfilled.

Sola Scriptura 2:7
The Faithfulness of God

FOCUS: TRUSTING IN GOD'S UNWAVERING FAITHFULNESS TO HIS PROMISES AND HIS PEOPLE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Lamentations 3:22-23
- Deuteronomy 7:9
- Psalm 36:5

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Corinthians 1:9
- Hebrews 10:23
- Isaiah 25:1
- 2 Thessalonians 3:3

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's faithfulness is a cornerstone of His character, ensuring He keeps His promises and remains steadfast in His love (Lamentations 3:22-23, Deuteronomy 7:9).
- Believers can trust in His faithfulness during all circumstances, knowing He strengthens and sustains them (Psalm 36:5, 2 Thessalonians 3:3).
- His faithfulness inspires confidence and hope, enabling believers to persevere in faith and obedience (Hebrews 10:23, Isaiah 25:1).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Lamentations 3:22-23 teach about God's faithfulness?**
   - His mercies are new every morning, reflecting His constant love and dependability.
2. **How does Deuteronomy 7:9 describe God's faithfulness?**
   - God is unchanging and faithful to keep His covenant and show love to those who obey Him.
3. **What is the significance of Hebrews 10:23 for believers?**
   - It encourages holding firmly to hope, grounded in the assurance of God's faithful promises.
4. **How can believers experience God's faithfulness daily?**
   - By meditating on His Word, recalling His past faithfulness, and trusting His provision (Psalm 36:5).
5. **What steps can you take to reflect God's faithfulness in your life?**
   - Be reliable in commitments, act with integrity, and trust God fully in challenges (1 Corinthians 1:9).

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on God's Faithfulness**: Write down examples of God's faithfulness in your life.
2. **Trust His Promises**: Identify a current challenge and commit to trusting God's faithfulness through it.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share a testimony of God's faithfulness to inspire someone.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His steadfast faithfulness and love.
2. Pray for trust in His promises, even in uncertain times.
3. Ask for strength to reflect His faithfulness in your words and actions.

Sola Scriptura 2:8
Overcoming Fear with Faith

FOCUS: REPLACING FEAR WITH TRUST IN GOD'S POWER, PRESENCE, AND PROMISES.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Isaiah 41:10
- 2 Timothy 1:7
- Psalm 56:3-4

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Joshua 1:9
- John 14:27
- Romans 8:15
- 1 John 4:18

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Faith in God replaces fear, as His presence and power provide security and peace (Isaiah 41:10, John 14:27).
- Believers are called to embrace courage, knowing God's Spirit equips them with strength, love, and self-discipline (2 Timothy 1:7, Joshua 1:9).
- Trusting in God's perfect love drives out fear and fosters confidence in His care (Psalm 56:3-4, 1 John 4:18).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Isaiah 41:10 teach about overcoming fear?**
   - It reminds believers of God's presence, strength, and help in every situation.
2. **How does 2 Timothy 1:7 encourage confidence instead of fear?**
   - God's Spirit empowers believers with boldness, love, and discipline, replacing timidity.
3. **What does it mean that "perfect love drives out fear" (1 John 4:18)?**
   - God's perfect love assures believers of His care, removing fear of judgment or harm.
4. **How can believers experience God's peace in fearful situations (John 14:27)?**
   - By focusing on Christ's promises, praying for peace, and surrendering worries to Him.
5. **What practical steps can you take to overcome fear with faith?**
   - Meditate on Scriptures about courage, pray for God's peace, and act in obedience despite fear.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Identify a Fear**: Write down a specific fear and pray for God's peace and strength to overcome it.
2. **Claim God's Promises**: Memorize Isaiah 41:10 or another verse about fear and recite it when fear arises.
3. **Step Out in Faith**: Take one action this week to confront a fear, trusting in God's presence and help.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His power and presence that dispel fear.
2. Pray for courage and trust in areas where fear feels overwhelming.
3. Ask for opportunities to encourage others to replace fear with faith.

Sola Scriptura 2:9
Living Out Your Identity in Christ

FOCUS: EMBRACING AND LIVING CONFIDENTLY IN THE TRUTH OF WHO WE ARE IN CHRIST.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Corinthians 5:17
- Galatians 2:20
- 1 Peter 2:9

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 1:3-14
- Romans 8:16-17
- Colossians 3:1-3
- Philippians 3:20

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- In Christ, believers are new creations, freed from sin's power and given a new identity rooted in God's love and purpose (2 Corinthians 5:17, Galatians 2:20).
- This identity includes being God's children, heirs with Christ, and members of His royal priesthood (1 Peter 2:9, Romans 8:16-17).
- Living out this identity involves rejecting worldly values, setting hearts on eternal priorities, and reflecting Christ's character (Ephesians 1:3-14, Colossians 3:1-3).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to be a new creation in Christ (2 Corinthians 5:17)?**
   - It means being transformed by God's grace, leaving behind sin and embracing a life of righteousness.
2. **How does Galatians 2:20 describe a believer's identity?**
   - Christ now lives in us, shaping our actions, desires, and purpose.
3. **What does 1 Peter 2:9 reveal about believers' purpose?**
   - As God's chosen people, believers are called to declare His praises and reflect His holiness.
4. **How can believers live with confidence in their heavenly citizenship (Philippians 3:20)?**
   - By focusing on God's promises, prioritizing eternal values, and living with hope in Christ's return.
5. **What practical steps can you take to embrace your identity in Christ?**
   - Spend time in Scripture, reject lies about your worth, and live boldly as a reflection of God's love.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Declare Your Identity**: Write down key truths about who you are in Christ and recite them daily.
2. **Live It Out**: Identify one area of your life where you can more fully reflect your identity in Christ.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share with someone the hope and confidence that come from knowing their identity in Christ.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Praise God for making you a new creation and giving you a purpose in Him.
2. Pray for confidence to live boldly in your identity as God's child.
3. Ask for opportunities to encourage others to embrace their identity in Christ.

Sola Scriptura 2:10
The Hope of Eternal Life

FOCUS: EMBRACING THE CERTAINTY AND JOY OF ETERNAL LIFE PROMISED THROUGH JESUS CHRIST.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- John 3:16
- Titus 1:2
- Revelation 21:1-4

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 John 5:11-12
- 2 Corinthians 5:1
- Romans 6:23
- Hebrews 11:16

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Eternal life is the free gift of God through faith in Jesus, offering the promise of living forever in His presence (John 3:16, Romans 6:23).
- This hope is secure, based on God's unchanging promise, and sustains believers through life's challenges (Titus 1:2, 2 Corinthians 5:1).
- The reality of eternal life inspires believers to live with joy, purpose, and a focus on eternal priorities (Revelation 21:1-4, Hebrews 11:16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does John 3:16 teach about the basis of eternal life?**
   - It is a gift from God, received by believing in Jesus, securing freedom from death and eternal separation from God.
2. **How does Titus 1:2 assure believers of the certainty of eternal life?**
   - It emphasizes God's faithfulness, highlighting that He never lies and His promise of eternal life is secure.
3. **What picture of eternal life is given in Revelation 21:1-4?**
   - A future of perfect peace, joy, and fellowship with God, free from pain, death, and sorrow.
4. **How can the hope of eternal life impact daily living (Hebrews 11:16)?**
   - It shifts focus from earthly struggles to heavenly rewards, motivating perseverance and faithful living.
5. **What practical steps can you take to live with an eternal perspective?**
   - Reflect on God's promises, prioritize spiritual over material pursuits, and share the gospel with others.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on Eternity**: Spend time meditating on Scriptures that describe the hope of heaven.
2. **Encourage Others**: Share with someone the joy and assurance of eternal life in Christ.
3. **Live with Purpose**: Choose one area of your life to align more closely with eternal priorities.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of eternal life through Jesus.
2. Pray for hope and joy in anticipation of living forever with Him.
3. Ask for boldness to share the promise of eternal life with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:11
God's Call to Generosity

FOCUS: REFLECTING GOD'S HEART THROUGH GIVING OF TIME, RESOURCES, AND LOVE TO OTHERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Corinthians 9:6-7
- Proverbs 11:25
- Acts 20:35

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Luke 6:38
- 1 Timothy 6:17-19
- Matthew 25:40
- James 2:14-17

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Generosity reflects God's character, as He gave His Son for humanity and provides abundantly for His children (2 Corinthians 9:6-7, Acts 20:35).
- Believers are called to give sacrificially, cheerfully, and intentionally, trusting God to meet their needs and bless their obedience (Proverbs 11:25, Luke 6:38).
- Generosity is an act of faith and a witness to God's love, meeting both physical and spiritual needs (1 Timothy 6:17-19, Matthew 25:40).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to be a cheerful giver (2 Corinthians 9:6-7)?**
   - It means giving willingly, joyfully, and out of love, not out of obligation or guilt.
2. **How does Proverbs 11:25 describe the blessings of generosity?**
   - It teaches that generosity refreshes both the giver and the recipient, fostering mutual blessing.
3. **What does Jesus emphasize about giving in Matthew 25:40?**
   - Acts of generosity toward others are seen as acts of service to Him.
4. **How can believers practice generosity in non-material ways?**
   - By giving time, encouragement, and acts of service to meet emotional and spiritual needs (James 2:14-17).
5. **What steps can you take to grow in generosity?**
   - Pray for a generous heart, plan intentional acts of giving, and trust God to provide for your needs.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Give Intentionally**: Choose one person or cause to support with your time, resources, or skills this week.
2. **Reflect on God's Generosity**: Spend time thanking God for His abundant provision in your life.
3. **Encourage Generosity**: Inspire someone else to give by sharing how generosity has impacted you.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His generosity in your life and His example of sacrificial giving.
2. Pray for a heart that reflects His generosity in all areas of your life.
3. Ask for wisdom and opportunities to bless others through giving.

Sola Scriptura 2:12
The Role of Worship in Spiritual Growth

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING WORSHIP AS A VITAL EXPRESSION OF LOVE AND REVERENCE FOR GOD THAT DEEPENS SPIRITUAL MATURITY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- John 4:23-24
- Romans 12:1
- Psalm 95:6-7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 12:28-29
- Psalm 100:4
- Colossians 3:16
- Exodus 34:14

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Worship is more than singing; it is a lifestyle of surrender, reflecting God's worth and holiness (John 4:23-24, Romans 12:1).
- Through worship, believers align their hearts with God's truth, experiencing His presence and growing in faith (Psalm 95:6-7, Hebrews 12:28-29).
- Genuine worship flows from gratitude and reverence, drawing believers closer to God and transforming their lives (Psalm 100:4, Colossians 3:16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to worship in spirit and truth (John 4:23-24)?**
   - It means worshiping with sincerity, guided by the Holy Spirit and rooted in the truth of God's Word.
2. **How is worship a living sacrifice (Romans 12:1)?**
   - It involves offering every aspect of life—actions, thoughts, and decisions—as an act of devotion to God.
3. **How does worship contribute to spiritual growth?**
   - Worship deepens intimacy with God, renews the mind, and fosters gratitude and humility (Psalm 95:6-7).
4. **What are some ways to practice worship beyond music?**
   - Prayer, acts of service, Scripture meditation, and expressing gratitude are all forms of worship (Hebrews 12:28-29).
5. **What steps can you take to make worship a daily practice?**
   - Set aside time for personal worship, incorporate gratitude into daily routines, and engage in corporate worship with others.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Start a Worship Routine**: Dedicate time each day for worship through prayer, music, or Scripture.
2. **Evaluate Your Worship**: Reflect on areas where you can deepen your reverence and focus on God.
3. **Engage in Corporate Worship**: Commit to participating in church gatherings and encouraging others in worship.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Praise God for who He is and His greatness.
2. Pray for a heart that worships Him fully in spirit and truth.
3. Ask for opportunities to lead or encourage others in worship.

Sola Scriptura 2:13

The Power of Gratitude

FOCUS: CULTIVATING A HEART OF THANKFULNESS THAT HONORS GOD AND TRANSFORMS ATTITUDES AND RELATIONSHIPS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Thessalonians 5:18
- Psalm 107:1
- Philippians 4:6-7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Colossians 3:17
- Ephesians 5:20
- Luke 17:15-16
- James 1:17

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Gratitude is a command and a response to God's goodness, expressing thankfulness in every circumstance (1 Thessalonians 5:18, Psalm 107:1).
- Thankfulness brings peace and joy, focusing hearts on God's provision and faithfulness rather than life's challenges (Philippians 4:6-7, Ephesians 5:20).
- A thankful heart strengthens relationships, inspires worship, and aligns believers with God's will (Luke 17:15-16, Colossians 3:17).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 Thessalonians 5:18 teach about gratitude?**
   - Gratitude is God's will and should be practiced in all circumstances, reflecting trust in His sovereignty.
2. **How does gratitude bring peace and joy (Philippians 4:6-7)?**
   - Thanking God shifts focus from anxiety to His provision, inviting His peace to guard our hearts.
3. **Why is gratitude important in relationships?**
   - It fosters appreciation, reduces conflict, and encourages generosity and forgiveness (Ephesians 5:20).
4. **What can we learn from the one leper in Luke 17:15-16?**
   - Gratitude glorifies God and deepens faith, as it acknowledges His work and blessings.
5. **How can believers cultivate a habit of gratitude?**
   - Keep a gratitude journal, express thanks in prayer, and intentionally acknowledge God's blessings daily.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Start a Gratitude Journal**: Write down three things you are thankful for each day this week.
2. **Thank Someone**: Identify a person who has blessed you and express your gratitude to them.
3. **Incorporate Thanksgiving in Prayer**: Begin each prayer by thanking God for specific blessings.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His faithfulness and blessings in your life.
2. Pray for a heart that remains grateful in all circumstances.
3. Ask for opportunities to express gratitude to others.

Sola Scriptura 2:14

Facing Temptation with God's Help

FOCUS: RELYING ON GOD'S STRENGTH AND PROMISES TO RESIST AND OVERCOME TEMPTATION.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Corinthians 10:13
- James 4:7
- Matthew 26:41

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 2:18
- Psalm 119:11
- Ephesians 6:11
- Genesis 39:9

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Temptation is common to all, but God provides strength and a way of escape for those who rely on Him (1 Corinthians 10:13, Matthew 26:41).
- Resisting temptation requires submitting to God, standing firm in faith, and using His Word as a defense (James 4:7, Psalm 119:11).
- Jesus, having faced temptation, empathizes with believers and provides help in their struggles (Hebrews 2:18, Ephesians 6:11).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 Corinthians 10:13 teach about God's help in temptation?**
   - God ensures that no temptation is beyond our ability to bear and always provides a way of escape.

2. **How does James 4:7 encourage victory over temptation?**
   - By submitting to God's authority and resisting the devil's lies, believers can overcome temptation.
3. **What role does prayer play in overcoming temptation (Matthew 26:41)?**
   - Prayer strengthens believers, keeping them alert and dependent on God's power to resist.
4. **How did Joseph's response in Genesis 39:9 demonstrate reliance on God?**
   - He honored God by refusing sin, prioritizing faithfulness over momentary pleasure.
5. **What practical steps can believers take to prepare for and resist temptation?**
   - Study Scripture, maintain accountability, avoid triggers, and pray for strength and discernment.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Memorize Scripture**: Choose a verse about temptation to recite when faced with challenges.
2. **Identify Weak Areas**: Reflect on areas of vulnerability and develop strategies to avoid or resist temptation.
3. **Seek Accountability**: Partner with a trusted friend or mentor for support in overcoming specific temptations.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His faithfulness in providing a way out of every temptation.
2. Pray for strength and wisdom to resist specific temptations you face.
3. Ask for guidance to encourage others in their battle against temptation.

Sola Scriptura 2:15

God's Power in Weakness

FOCUS: EXPERIENCING GOD'S STRENGTH AND GRACE IN TIMES OF PERSONAL WEAKNESS AND INADEQUACY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Corinthians 12:9-10
- Isaiah 40:29
- Philippians 4:13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Psalm 73:26
- Exodus 4:10-12
- Hebrews 4:16
- Romans 8:26

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's strength is most evident in human weakness, showcasing His sufficiency and power (2 Corinthians 12:9-10, Psalm 73:26).
- Weakness becomes an opportunity to rely fully on God's grace and experience His provision (Isaiah 40:29, Philippians 4:13).
- The Holy Spirit sustains and empowers believers, interceding on their behalf and enabling them to endure challenges (Romans 8:26, Exodus 4:10-12).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 2 Corinthians 12:9-10 teach about weakness?**
   - Weakness is a platform for God's power to work, teaching believers to rely on His grace.
2. **How does Isaiah 40:29 encourage those who feel weak or weary?**
   - It promises God's strength for the weary, assuring His help for those who trust Him.
3. **What role does the Holy Spirit play in our weakness (Romans 8:26)?**
   - The Spirit intercedes for believers, providing strength, guidance, and comfort in their struggles.
4. **How can Philippians 4:13 apply to daily challenges?**
   - It reminds believers that God provides strength for every task and trial they face.
5. **What practical steps can you take to trust God's power in your weakness?**
   - Surrender control to Him, pray for His strength, and act in faith despite limitations.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Surrender Your Weakness**: Write down areas where you feel weak and commit them to God in prayer.
2. **Rely on His Strength**: Memorize Philippians 4:13 and recite it when facing challenges.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share a time when God's power worked through your weakness to encourage someone.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His grace that sustains you in weakness.
2. Pray for trust in His strength to handle your current struggles.
3. Ask for opportunities to rely on and reflect His power in your life.

Sola Scriptura 2:16

The Peace of Reconciliation

FOCUS: EMBRACING THE PEACE THAT COMES FROM RECONCILIATION WITH GOD AND OTHERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 5:1
- 2 Corinthians 5:18-19
- Matthew 5:23-24

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Colossians 1:19-20
- Ephesians 4:31-32
- Matthew 6:14-15
- James 3:18

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Reconciliation with God, through Christ's sacrifice, restores peace and eliminates the separation caused by sin (Romans 5:1, Colossians 1:19-20).
- Believers are called to extend this reconciliation to others, seeking peace in relationships and forgiving as God forgives (2 Corinthians 5:18-19, Ephesians 4:31-32).
- True reconciliation fosters unity, spiritual growth, and a witness to God's transforming power (Matthew 5:23-24, James 3:18).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Romans 5:1 teach about reconciliation with God?**
   - It assures believers of peace with God through faith in Christ, reconciling them to Him.
2. **How does 2 Corinthians 5:18-19 describe the ministry of reconciliation?**
   - It involves sharing the gospel and actively seeking to restore broken relationships.
3. **What does Jesus teach about reconciliation in Matthew 5:23-24?**
   - Reconciliation with others is essential for worship, highlighting its priority in God's eyes.
4. **Why is forgiveness essential for reconciliation (Ephesians 4:31-32)?**
   - Forgiveness reflects God's grace and breaks barriers that hinder peace and unity.
5. **What practical steps can you take to pursue reconciliation in a broken relationship?**
   - Pray for guidance, approach the person humbly, and prioritize forgiveness and understanding.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Seek Reconciliation**: Identify a strained relationship and take steps toward restoration this week.
2. **Reflect God's Forgiveness**: Meditate on how God has forgiven you and extend that grace to others.
3. **Be a Peacemaker**: Look for ways to foster peace and unity in your community or church.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for reconciling you to Himself through Christ.
2. Pray for the courage to seek reconciliation in difficult relationships.
3. Ask for wisdom and grace to be a peacemaker in your interactions.

Sola Scriptura 2:17

Faith That Moves Mountains

FOCUS: CULTIVATING BOLD, UNSHAKABLE FAITH THAT TRUSTS GOD TO WORK IN SEEMINGLY IMPOSSIBLE SITUATIONS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 17:20
- Hebrews 11:6
- Mark 11:23

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 10:17
- James 2:17
- Luke 1:37
- John 15:7

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Faith is a gift and a choice to trust in God's power, promises, and faithfulness, even when circumstances seem impossible (Matthew 17:20, Luke 1:37).
- Genuine faith is active, demonstrated through obedience and prayer, and pleases God (Hebrews 11:6, James 2:17).
- Bold faith aligns with God's will, allowing believers to see His power at work in miraculous ways (Mark 11:23, John 15:7).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does it mean to have faith as small as a mustard seed (Matthew 17:20)?**
   - Even small, genuine faith in God's power can accomplish great things because it relies on Him.
2. **Why is faith essential to pleasing God (Hebrews 11:6)?**
   - Faith demonstrates trust in His character and His ability to fulfill His promises.
3. **How does Mark 11:23 encourage bold prayers?**
   - It teaches that faith, without doubting, enables believers to trust God for extraordinary outcomes.
4. **What role does Scripture play in building faith (Romans 10:17)?**
   - Hearing and meditating on God's Word strengthens trust in His promises and power.
5. **How can believers act on their faith daily (James 2:17)?**
   - By obeying God's commands, stepping out in trust, and praying boldly for His will to be done.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Pray Boldly**: Identify a "mountain" in your life and pray with faith for God's intervention.
2. **Act on Your Faith**: Take a practical step this week that demonstrates trust in God's promises.
3. **Encourage Faith**: Share a testimony of how God has worked through faith in your life.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His power and faithfulness to work through faith.
2. Pray for bold, unwavering trust in Him for impossible situations.
3. Ask for strength to act on your faith and encourage others to do the same.

Sola Scriptura 2:18

The Rewards of Obedience

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE BLESSINGS AND FULFILLMENT THAT COME FROM LIVING IN OBEDIENCE TO GOD'S WORD.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Deuteronomy 28:1-2
- John 14:23
- James 1:25

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Psalm 119:1-2
- 1 Samuel 15:22
- Isaiah 1:19
- Matthew 7:24-27

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Obedience to God flows from love and trust, leading to spiritual and practical blessings (Deuteronomy 28:1-2, John 14:23).
- It is better than ritual or sacrifice, reflecting a heart fully devoted to God's will (1 Samuel 15:22, Isaiah 1:19).
- Obedience provides a firm foundation for life, resulting in freedom, joy, and resilience in trials (James 1:25, Matthew 7:24-27).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What blessings are promised for obedience in Deuteronomy 28:1-2?**
   - God promises His presence, provision, and favor to those who faithfully follow His commands.
2. **How does John 14:23 connect obedience with love for God?**
   - Loving God naturally leads to obeying His teaching, deepening fellowship with Him.
3. **What does it mean that obedience is better than sacrifice (1 Samuel 15:22)?**
   - God values a heart that willingly follows Him over external religious rituals.
4. **How does James 1:25 describe the rewards of obedience?**
   - Obedience to God's Word brings freedom, blessing, and fulfillment.
5. **What practical steps can you take to grow in obedience to God?**
   - Spend time studying His Word, pray for guidance, and act on His commands daily.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on Obedience**: Identify an area where God is calling you to greater obedience and take action this week.
2. **Memorize Scripture**: Choose a verse about obedience to encourage you in following God's will.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share how obedience to God has brought blessings in your life.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the blessings that come through obedience.
2. Pray for strength and courage to follow His commands fully.
3. Ask for wisdom to discern His will in your daily life.

Sola Scriptura 2:19
Finding Joy in Trials

FOCUS: EMBRACING JOY IN THE MIDST OF TRIALS BY TRUSTING IN GOD'S PURPOSES AND PROMISES.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- James 1:2-4
- Romans 5:3-5
- 1 Peter 1:6-7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- John 16:33
- 2 Corinthians 4:16-18
- Philippians 4:4
- Psalm 30:5

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Trials are opportunities for growth, shaping character and faith while drawing believers closer to God (James 1:2-4, Romans 5:3-5).
- Joy in trials is not based on circumstances but on the assurance of God's presence, promises, and ultimate victory (1 Peter 1:6-7, John 16:33).
- Suffering is temporary and purposeful, producing eternal rewards and deepening spiritual maturity (2 Corinthians 4:16-18, Psalm 30:5).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does James 1:2-4 teach about joy in trials?**
   - Trials produce perseverance and maturity, leading believers to greater reliance on God.
2. **How can suffering produce hope, as described in Romans 5:3-5?**
   - Perseverance and character formed through suffering strengthen confidence in God's love and faithfulness.
3. **What does 1 Peter 1:6-7 reveal about the purpose of trials?**
   - Trials refine faith, proving its genuineness and bringing glory to God.
4. **How can believers rejoice during difficult times (Philippians 4:4)?**
   - By focusing on God's presence, promises, and power rather than their circumstances.
5. **What practical steps can you take to find joy in trials?**
   - Pray for God's perspective, meditate on His promises, and seek support from fellow believers.

APPLICATIONS:

- **Reflect on Trials**: Identify a current or past trial and write down how God has worked through it.
- **Rejoice in God's Promises**: Spend time worshiping and thanking God for His faithfulness in difficulties.
- **Encourage Someone**: Share how God has brought joy or growth through your trials to encourage someone facing challenges.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His presence and purpose in trials.
2. Pray for perseverance and joy in your current challenges.
3. Ask for wisdom to encourage others facing difficulties.

Sola Scriptura 2:20

The Depth of God's Love

FOCUS: GRASPING THE IMMEASURABLE AND SACRIFICIAL LOVE OF GOD THAT TRANSFORMS AND SUSTAINS BELIEVERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 8:38-39
- Ephesians 3:17-19
- John 15:13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 John 3:1
- Psalm 103:11-12
- Isaiah 54:10
- John 3:16

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's love is boundless and unconditional, demonstrated through Christ's sacrifice on the cross (Romans 8:38-39, John 15:13).
- His love sustains believers, offering security, hope, and assurance in every situation (Ephesians 3:17-19, Isaiah 54:10).
- Understanding and experiencing God's love inspires worship, obedience, and love for others (1 John 3:1, Psalm 103:11-12).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Romans 8:38-39 teach about God's love?**
   - God's love is inseparable, enduring through every circumstance and challenge.
2. **How does Ephesians 3:17-19 describe the dimensions of Christ's love?**
   - It is immeasurable, surpassing human understanding and filling believers with God's fullness.
3. **What is the greatest demonstration of God's love (John 15:13, John 3:16)?**
   - Jesus' sacrificial death on the cross, offering eternal life to all who believe.
4. **How does understanding God's love impact daily life?**
   - It brings peace, confidence, and motivation to love and serve others (Isaiah 54:10).
5. **What practical steps can you take to grow in your understanding of God's love?**
   - Spend time in Scripture, pray for a deeper experience of His love, and reflect it in your relationships.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Meditate on God's Love**: Spend time each day reflecting on Scriptures about God's love.
2. **Share His Love**: Look for opportunities to demonstrate God's love to someone in need.
3. **Celebrate His Love**: Write a prayer or song of thanksgiving for God's unfailing love.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Praise God for the depth and constancy of His love.
2. Pray for a deeper understanding of His love and how to reflect it to others.
3. Ask for boldness to share His love with someone who needs to hear it.

Sola Scriptura 2:21
Placing Oneself Under the Authority of the Pastor

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLICAL PRINCIPLE OF RESPECTING AND SUBMITTING TO PASTORAL LEADERSHIP AS PART OF GOD'S DESIGN FOR THE CHURCH.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 13:17
- 1 Thessalonians 5:12-13
- Ephesians 4:11-13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Timothy 5:17
- Acts 20:28
- 2 Timothy 4:2
- 1 Corinthians 16:15-16

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God has established pastoral leadership to shepherd His people, guide them in spiritual growth, and protect the Church from false teachings (Ephesians 4:11-13, Acts 20:28).
- Submitting to the authority of pastors demonstrates humility, trust in God's order, and respect for those tasked with watching over souls (Hebrews 13:17, 1 Thessalonians 5:12-13).

- Pastors are accountable to God for their leadership, and believers are called to support, encourage, and honor them as they fulfill their responsibilities (1 Timothy 5:17, 2 Timothy 4:2).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Hebrews 13:17 teach about the role of pastors?**
   - Pastors are entrusted with the spiritual well-being of their congregations and will give an account to God for their leadership.
2. **Why is it important to honor and submit to pastoral leadership (1 Thessalonians 5:12-13)?**
   - It fosters unity, respect, and an environment where the Church can grow in love and truth under God's direction.
3. **How does Ephesians 4:11-13 describe the purpose of pastors and teachers?**
   - They equip the Church for service, build up the body of Christ, and help believers reach maturity in faith.
4. **What are practical ways to support and encourage your pastor (1 Timothy 5:17)?**
   - Pray for them, follow their guidance, offer words of encouragement, and participate actively in church ministry.
5. **How can you maintain a healthy attitude toward pastoral authority?**
   - Recognize their calling from God, remember their accountability to Him, and approach any concerns with humility and prayer.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Pray for Your Pastor**: Commit to praying regularly for your pastor's wisdom, health, and ministry.
2. **Encourage Your Pastor**: Write a note of gratitude or offer verbal encouragement for their leadership.

3. **Follow Their Leadership**: Identify one area where you can better support your pastor's vision for the church.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for your pastor and the leadership they provide to your church.
2. Pray for their spiritual strength, clarity in preaching, and protection against discouragement.
3. Ask for humility and wisdom to submit to their authority and contribute to the unity of the Church.

Sola Scriptura 2:22

The Role of Church Leadership

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE PURPOSE AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF CHURCH LEADERSHIP AS DESIGNED BY GOD TO SHEPHERD, EQUIP, AND UNIFY THE BODY OF CHRIST.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Timothy 3:1-7
- 1 Peter 5:2-3
- Ephesians 4:11-13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Acts 20:28
- Titus 1:7-9
- Hebrews 13:17
- Proverbs 11:14

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Church leadership, including pastors, elders, and deacons, is established by God to provide guidance, spiritual oversight, and teaching (Ephesians 4:11-13, Acts 20:28).
- Leaders are called to shepherd the flock with humility, serve as examples, and maintain integrity in their personal and public lives (1 Peter 5:2-3, Titus 1:7-9).
- Believers are encouraged to support and respect their leaders, recognizing the weight of their responsibility before God (Hebrews 13:17, Proverbs 11:14).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Ephesians 4:11-13 teach about the purpose of church leadership?**
   - Leadership equips the Church for service, builds unity, and promotes spiritual maturity.
2. **How does 1 Timothy 3:1-7 outline the qualifications for church leaders?**
   - Leaders must be above reproach, self-controlled, hospitable, able to teach, and faithful in their relationships.
3. **What is the role of humility in church leadership (1 Peter 5:2-3)?**
   - Leaders are called to shepherd the flock willingly and as examples, avoiding domineering behavior.
4. **Why is it important to respect and support church leaders (Hebrews 13:17)?**
   - Respecting leaders fosters unity and allows them to serve joyfully, benefiting the Church as a whole.
5. **How can you contribute to the effectiveness of church leadership?**
   - Pray for leaders, follow their guidance, and actively participate in the church's mission.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Pray for Your Leaders**: Commit to praying regularly for your church's pastors, elders, and deacons.
2. **Encourage Them**: Express gratitude for their service through a note, email, or verbal encouragement.
3. **Engage in the Mission**: Look for ways to actively support the vision and goals of your church leadership.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of leadership within the Church.
2. Pray for wisdom, integrity, and perseverance for your church leaders.
3. Ask for humility and a spirit of unity as you support their ministry.

Sola Scriptura 2:23
Accountability Within the Body of Christ

FOCUS: EMBRACING MUTUAL ACCOUNTABILITY AS A MEANS OF SPIRITUAL GROWTH, ENCOURAGEMENT, AND PROTECTION FROM SIN.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- James 5:16
- Galatians 6:1-2
- Proverbs 27:17

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ecclesiastes 4:9-10
- Matthew 18:15-17
- Hebrews 10:24-25
- Romans 15:1-2

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Accountability in the body of Christ fosters spiritual growth, healing, and encouragement, as believers confess sins, share burdens, and challenge one another (James 5:16, Galatians 6:1-2).
- It reflects Christ's love and care, ensuring members support and correct each other in humility and truth (Proverbs 27:17, Matthew 18:15-17).
- Healthy accountability builds unity, strengthens faith, and prevents isolation or spiritual stagnation (Hebrews 10:24-25, Ecclesiastes 4:9-10).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does James 5:16 teach about the role of confession in accountability?**
   - Confession brings healing and fosters mutual support through prayer and encouragement.
2. **How does Galatians 6:1-2 describe the responsibility of believers toward one another?**
   - Believers are called to restore gently and bear each other's burdens, fulfilling Christ's law of love.
3. **What does Proverbs 27:17 reveal about the benefits of accountability?**
   - Accountability sharpens character and faith, promoting spiritual growth and wisdom.
4. **How can believers address sin in a loving and biblical way (Matthew 18:15-17)?**
   - By approaching the person privately, then involving others if needed, and always aiming for restoration.
5. **What practical steps can you take to build accountability in your life?**
   - Join a small group, seek a mentor, and be transparent with trusted Christian friends.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Join a Group**: Participate in a small group or accountability partnership within your church.
2. **Be Honest**: Identify one area where you need accountability and share it with a trusted believer.
3. **Support Others**: Offer to be an accountability partner for someone who needs encouragement.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of community and mutual accountability.
2. Pray for wisdom and humility in giving and receiving correction.
3. Ask for opportunities to build and strengthen accountability relationships.

Sola Scriptura 2:24
Stewardship of Spiritual Gifts

FOCUS: USING THE SPIRITUAL GIFTS GOD HAS GIVEN TO SERVE THE CHURCH AND ADVANCE HIS KINGDOM.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Peter 4:10
- 1 Corinthians 12:4-7
- Romans 12:6-8

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 4:11-12
- Matthew 25:14-30
- 1 Corinthians 14:12
- 2 Timothy 1:6

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Spiritual gifts are given by the Holy Spirit for the purpose of serving others and glorifying God (1 Peter 4:10, 1 Corinthians 12:4-7).
- Each believer has unique gifts that contribute to the health and mission of the Church (Romans 12:6-8, Ephesians 4:11-12).
- Faithful stewardship of these gifts involves using them intentionally and developing them for maximum impact (Matthew 25:14-30, 2 Timothy 1:6).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What is the purpose of spiritual gifts (1 Corinthians 12:4-7)?**
   - To build up the Church, serve others, and glorify God.
2. **How does 1 Peter 4:10 encourage stewardship of gifts?**
   - It calls believers to use their gifts to serve others as faithful stewards of God's grace.
3. **What does the parable of the talents teach about stewardship (Matthew 25:14-30)?**
   - It emphasizes the importance of using and multiplying what God has entrusted to us.
4. **How can believers identify their spiritual gifts?**
   - Through prayer, seeking counsel, serving in various roles, and observing where God's blessing is evident (Romans 12:6-8).
5. **What practical steps can you take to grow in using your gifts?**
   - Volunteer in your church, seek training or mentorship, and pray for guidance and boldness.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Discover Your Gifts**: Take a spiritual gifts assessment or ask others to affirm your strengths.
2. **Use Your Gifts**: Find a ministry or role in your church where you can serve with your gifts.
3. **Develop Your Gifts**: Commit to learning and growing in your gifting through study or mentorship.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the spiritual gifts He has entrusted to you.
2. Pray for wisdom and opportunities to use your gifts effectively.
3. Ask for boldness and creativity in serving others through your gifts.

Sola Scriptura 2:25
The Importance of Corporate Fellowship

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE SIGNIFICANCE OF GATHERING TOGETHER AS A COMMUNITY OF BELIEVERS TO WORSHIP, GROW, AND ENCOURAGE ONE ANOTHER.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 10:24-25
- Acts 2:42
- Matthew 18:20

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Psalm 133:1
- 1 Corinthians 12:12-14
- Colossians 3:16
- Ecclesiastes 4:9-12

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Corporate fellowship strengthens believers by providing encouragement, accountability, and spiritual growth (Hebrews 10:24-25, Acts 2:42).
- Gathering together as the Body of Christ reflects God's design for unity, where each member contributes to the whole (1 Corinthians 12:12-14, Psalm 133:1).

- Worshiping and learning together enhances faith, fosters mutual support, and creates opportunities to serve one another in love (Matthew 18:20, Colossians 3:16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why does Hebrews 10:24-25 emphasize the importance of meeting together?**
   - Regular fellowship encourages spiritual growth, perseverance, and mutual support.
2. **How does Acts 2:42 describe the early Church's commitment to fellowship?**
   - They devoted themselves to teaching, prayer, and sharing meals, fostering unity and spiritual strength.
3. **What does Matthew 18:20 teach about the presence of Christ in fellowship?**
   - Christ is uniquely present when believers gather in His name, affirming the value of corporate worship.
4. **How does 1 Corinthians 12:12-14 illustrate the role of each believer in the Church?**
   - Each member of the Body of Christ has a unique role, and together, they function as one united community.
5. **What practical steps can believers take to prioritize corporate fellowship?**
   - Commit to regular church attendance, join a small group, and actively participate in community activities.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Engage in Fellowship**: Attend church regularly and participate in group activities or ministry teams.

2. **Build Relationships**: Take intentional steps to connect with other believers, such as inviting someone for coffee or joining a small group.
3. **Encourage Others**: Reach out to someone who may feel disconnected and invite them to join a fellowship event.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of fellowship and the encouragement it provides.
2. Pray for unity, love, and growth within your church community.
3. Ask for opportunities to support and encourage others in their faith journey.

Sola Scriptura 2:26

The Role of Hospitality in Ministry

FOCUS: EMBRACING HOSPITALITY AS A WAY TO REFLECT GOD'S LOVE AND BUILD RELATIONSHIPS WITHIN THE CHURCH AND THE WORLD.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Peter 4:9
- Romans 12:13
- Hebrews 13:2

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 25:35
- Acts 16:14-15
- Luke 14:12-14
- 3 John 1:5-8

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Hospitality is a practical expression of love, welcoming others into our lives and meeting their needs (1 Peter 4:9, Romans 12:13).
- It is both a ministry and a command, fostering connection, encouragement, and outreach (Hebrews 13:2, Matthew 25:35).
- Biblical hospitality extends beyond family and friends, reflecting God's inclusive love and advancing His kingdom (Luke 14:12-14, Acts 16:14-15).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why is hospitality important in ministry (1 Peter 4:9)?**
   - It demonstrates love and care for others, building community and fostering unity in the Church.
2. **What does Romans 12:13 teach about sharing with others?**
   - It calls believers to meet practical needs and intentionally practice hospitality as a form of ministry.
3. **How does Hebrews 13:2 emphasize the significance of hospitality to strangers?**
   - It highlights that acts of kindness to strangers honor God and may have unexpected blessings.
4. **What does Luke 14:12-14 teach about selfless hospitality?**
   - It encourages serving those who cannot repay, mirroring God's grace and generosity.
5. **How can you practice hospitality in your own life?**
   - Open your home to others, serve meals to those in need, and create welcoming spaces for fellowship.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Open Your Home**: Host a meal or gathering for members of your church or community.
2. **Serve Strangers**: Look for opportunities to show hospitality to those outside your immediate circle.
3. **Encourage Through Hospitality**: Use hospitality as a way to build deeper relationships within your church.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His hospitality in welcoming you into His family.
2. Pray for a heart that reflects His love through hospitality.
3. Ask for opportunities to show kindness and generosity to others.

Sola Scriptura 2:27

Overcoming Division in the Church

FOCUS: PROMOTING UNITY AND LOVE WITHIN THE CHURCH BY ADDRESSING AND RESOLVING SOURCES OF DIVISION.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Corinthians 1:10
- Ephesians 4:2-3
- Colossians 3:13-14

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 14:19
- James 3:17-18
- Matthew 5:23-24
- Galatians 3:28

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Division within the Church undermines its mission and witness, but unity glorifies God and reflects His character (1 Corinthians 1:10, Colossians 3:13-14).
- Believers are called to pursue peace, forgiveness, and love, working diligently to resolve conflicts and promote harmony (Ephesians 4:2-3, Romans 14:19).
- Unity in the Church transcends differences, emphasizing shared faith in Christ as the foundation for reconciliation (Galatians 3:28, James 3:17-18).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 Corinthians 1:10 teach about unity in the Church?**
   - It calls for agreement and harmony, urging believers to set aside divisions and seek unity in thought and purpose.
2. **How does Ephesians 4:2-3 encourage believers to maintain unity?**
   - Through humility, gentleness, patience, and love, believers can preserve the bond of peace created by the Spirit.
3. **What role does forgiveness play in overcoming division (Colossians 3:13-14)?**
   - Forgiveness fosters reconciliation, restoring relationships and binding the Church together in love.
4. **How can believers handle disagreements in a biblical way (Matthew 5:23-24)?**
   - By seeking reconciliation directly and prioritizing peace over personal pride or grievances.
5. **What practical steps can you take to promote unity in your church?**
   - Address conflicts promptly, seek common ground, and focus on Christ's mission above personal preferences.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Address a Conflict**: Identify any unresolved tensions and take steps to reconcile this week.
2. **Foster Unity**: Participate in a team or group activity that builds relationships within your church.
3. **Pray for Peace**: Commit to praying for unity and love within your church body.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His unifying work through Christ in the Church.
2. Pray for wisdom and humility to address sources of division.
3. Ask for opportunities to promote peace and reconciliation in your community.

Sola Scriptura 2:28

The Joy of Serving Together

FOCUS: EXPERIENCING THE BLESSINGS AND JOY THAT COME FROM SERVING GOD ALONGSIDE FELLOW BELIEVERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Philippians 2:2
- 1 Corinthians 3:9
- Romans 12:4-5

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ecclesiastes 4:9
- 1 Peter 4:10-11
- Acts 6:2-7
- Psalm 133:1

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Serving together unites believers, strengthens relationships, and advances God's kingdom (Philippians 2:2, Romans 12:4-5).
- It reflects God's design for the Church as a body, where every member contributes to the whole (1 Corinthians 3:9, Ecclesiastes 4:9).
- Joy comes from working together in love, using diverse gifts for God's glory and the benefit of others (1 Peter 4:10-11, Psalm 133:1).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Philippians 2:2 teach about unity in serving?**
   - Unity in love and purpose brings joy to the Church and reflects Christ's heart.
2. **How does 1 Corinthians 3:9 describe believers' roles in God's work?**
   - Believers are co-workers, partnering in God's service and sharing in His mission.
3. **What are the benefits of serving together (Ecclesiastes 4:9)?**
   - Collaboration yields greater results, strengthens relationships, and fosters encouragement.
4. **How can believers use their gifts to serve together effectively (1 Peter 4:10-11)?**
   - By relying on God's strength, working with humility, and focusing on His glory.
5. **What practical steps can you take to serve alongside others in your church?**
   - Join a ministry team, participate in a service project, or invite others to collaborate on a mission effort.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Serve in a Team**: Volunteer for a ministry or outreach program in your church.
2. **Encourage Fellow Servants**: Acknowledge and appreciate the efforts of those you serve alongside.
3. **Foster Teamwork**: Look for ways to collaborate with others in serving your community.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the joy and unity found in serving together.
2. Pray for opportunities to use your gifts alongside others in ministry.
3. Ask for strength and encouragement for those serving in your church.

Sola Scriptura 2:29
Trusting God's Plan for the Future

FOCUS: EMBRACING FAITH IN GOD'S SOVEREIGNTY AND GUIDANCE AS WE FACE AN UNKNOWN FUTURE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Jeremiah 29:11
- Proverbs 3:5-6
- Romans 8:28

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Psalm 37:23-24
- Isaiah 55:8-9
- Philippians 1:6
- Matthew 6:34

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- God's plans for His people are good, filled with hope and purpose, even when the future seems uncertain (Jeremiah 29:11, Romans 8:28).
- Trusting in His sovereignty requires surrendering our own understanding and relying on His wisdom and timing (Proverbs 3:5-6, Isaiah 55:8-9).
- Believers can rest in the assurance that God is actively working for their good and will complete His work in their lives (Philippians 1:6, Psalm 37:23-24).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Jeremiah 29:11 teach about God's plans?**
   - God's plans are designed to bring hope, prosperity, and a future, reflecting His goodness and care.
2. **How does Proverbs 3:5-6 encourage trust in God's guidance?**
   - By calling believers to trust wholeheartedly in the Lord, acknowledging Him in all ways for clear direction.
3. **What assurance does Romans 8:28 provide for uncertain times?**
   - It promises that God is working all things together for the good of those who love Him.
4. **Why is surrendering our understanding important (Isaiah 55:8-9)?**
   - God's thoughts and ways are higher than ours, requiring faith in His perfect wisdom.
5. **What practical steps can you take to trust God's plan for the future?**
   - Pray for guidance, meditate on His promises, and take steps of obedience without fear.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Surrender Your Worries**: Write down your concerns about the future and pray over them, asking for God's peace.
2. **Reflect on God's Faithfulness**: Recall past instances where God has guided or provided for you.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share a testimony of how trusting God's plan brought peace and clarity.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His sovereignty and perfect plan for your life.
2. Pray for faith to trust Him with your future.
3. Ask for opportunities to encourage others who are struggling with uncertainty.

Sola Scriptura 2:30
The Discipline of Fasting

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE SPIRITUAL PURPOSE OF FASTING AND HOW IT DEEPENS DEPENDENCE ON GOD.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 6:16-18
- Isaiah 58:6-7
- Joel 2:12

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Acts 13:2-3
- Daniel 9:3
- Ezra 8:23
- Psalm 35:13

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Fasting is a voluntary act of humility and dependence on God, often combined with prayer to seek His presence and guidance (Matthew 6:16-18, Daniel 9:3).
- True fasting goes beyond abstaining from food, reflecting a heart aligned with God's will and a commitment to justice and mercy (Isaiah 58:6-7, Joel 2:12).
- Fasting strengthens faith, sharpens focus on God's purposes, and prepares believers for spiritual breakthrough (Acts 13:2-3, Ezra 8:23).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Matthew 6:16-18 teach about fasting?**
   - Fasting is to be done sincerely, not for show, as an act of worship and dependence on God.
2. **How does Isaiah 58:6-7 redefine the purpose of fasting?**
   - True fasting involves addressing injustice, helping the needy, and reflecting God's character.
3. **What role did fasting play in Acts 13:2-3?**
   - Fasting accompanied prayer as the church sought God's guidance for sending out missionaries.
4. **How does fasting deepen dependence on God (Joel 2:12)?**
   - It helps believers turn fully to God, expressing repentance and seeking His presence.
5. **What practical steps can you take to incorporate fasting into your spiritual life?**
   - Begin with a short fast, combine it with focused prayer, and ensure it is done with the right heart.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Plan a Fast**: Choose a day to fast and dedicate time to prayer and seeking God's guidance.
2. **Focus on God's Will**: Use your fasting time to pray for specific areas of growth or clarity in your life.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share your experience of fasting and how it deepened your walk with God.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the opportunity to draw closer to Him through fasting.
2. Pray for guidance and strength as you fast and seek His will.
3. Ask for spiritual breakthroughs in your life and the lives of others.

Sola Scriptura 2:31
God's Guidance Through Scripture

FOCUS: DISCOVERING GOD'S WILL AND DIRECTION BY MEDITATING ON HIS WORD.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Psalm 119:105
- 2 Timothy 3:16-17
- Joshua 1:8

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Proverbs 3:5-6
- Hebrews 4:12
- James 1:22-25
- John 15:7

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Scripture provides direction, wisdom, and correction, equipping believers for every good work (2 Timothy 3:16-17, Psalm 119:105).
- Meditating on God's Word allows it to transform minds, guide decisions, and strengthen faith (Joshua 1:8, Hebrews 4:12).
- Applying Scripture to daily life builds a foundation for obedience and intimacy with God (James 1:22-25, John 15:7).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Psalm 119:105 teach about the role of Scripture?**
   - God's Word provides clarity and direction in life's decisions and challenges.
2. **How does 2 Timothy 3:16-17 describe the usefulness of Scripture?**
   - It teaches, corrects, and trains believers, equipping them for every good work.
3. **Why is meditation on Scripture important (Joshua 1:8)?**
   - Meditation helps internalize God's Word, leading to obedience and prosperity in His will.
4. **How does Hebrews 4:12 highlight the power of God's Word?**
   - Scripture is alive and penetrates hearts, revealing truth and guiding believers in righteousness.
5. **What practical steps can you take to seek God's guidance through Scripture?**
   - Develop a regular reading plan, pray for understanding, and apply what you learn.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Start a Reading Plan**: Commit to reading a specific book of the Bible or following a daily devotional.
2. **Memorize Scripture**: Choose a verse to memorize and meditate on throughout the week.
3. **Apply the Word**: Identify one area of your life where you can act on God's guidance from Scripture.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His Word as a source of guidance and truth.
2. Pray for understanding and wisdom as you study Scripture.
3. Ask for strength to apply His Word to your daily life.

Sola Scriptura 2:32

Handling Tension Between Believers

- FOCUS: LEARNING BIBLICAL PRINCIPLES FOR ADDRESSING AND RESOLVING CONFLICTS WITHIN THE BODY OF CHRIST TO MAINTAIN UNITY AND LOVE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 18:15-17
- Ephesians 4:2-3
- Colossians 3:13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Proverbs 15:1
- Romans 12:18
- James 1:19
- Galatians 6:1

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Tension and disagreements are inevitable in relationships, but they should be addressed with humility, love, and a desire for restoration (Matthew 18:15-17, Ephesians 4:2-3).
- Forgiveness is foundational to resolving conflict, reflecting the grace that God has extended to us (Colossians 3:13).
- Effective communication, including listening well and speaking gently, helps to diffuse anger and promote understanding (Proverbs 15:1, James 1:19).
- The ultimate goal is to restore unity and peace, seeking reconciliation rather than division (Romans 12:18, Galatians 6:1).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Matthew 18:15-17 teach about resolving conflict?**
   - It provides a clear process for addressing issues privately, then with witnesses, and finally involving the church if necessary, aiming for restoration.
2. **How can Ephesians 4:2-3 guide us in handling tension?**
   - By encouraging humility, gentleness, patience, and love, which are essential for maintaining peace and unity.
3. **Why is forgiveness critical in conflict resolution (Colossians 3:13)?**
   - Forgiveness reflects God's grace and breaks the cycle of resentment, paving the way for reconciliation.
4. **What practical advice does James 1:19 offer for handling disagreements?**
   - It emphasizes the importance of listening carefully, controlling our words, and managing anger to foster understanding.
5. **What steps can you take to handle tension in a godly way?**
   - Pray for wisdom, approach the person with humility, listen actively, and prioritize reconciliation over being right.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Address a Current Conflict**: Identify a strained relationship and take steps to resolve it using the principles in Matthew 18:15-17.
2. **Practice Forgiveness**: Reflect on any grievances you hold and choose to forgive, asking God for the strength to let go.
3. **Promote Unity**: Be proactive in encouraging peace and understanding in your church or community.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Ask God for wisdom and humility in addressing conflicts.
2. Pray for the courage to approach others with love and grace.
3. Thank God for the forgiveness He has extended to you, and ask for His help to extend the same to others.

Sola Scriptura 2:33

The Danger of Lukewarm Faith

FOCUS: WARNING AGAINST COMPLACENCY IN THE CHRISTIAN WALK AND STRIVING FOR WHOLEHEARTED DEVOTION.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Revelation 3:15-16
- Matthew 22:37
- James 2:17

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Timothy 3:5
- Luke 9:23
- Colossians 3:23-24

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Lukewarm faith reflects spiritual apathy, which grieves God and diminishes the believer's witness (Revelation 3:15-16, 2 Timothy 3:5).
- God calls believers to wholehearted devotion, pursuing Him with passion and commitment (Matthew 22:37, Colossians 3:23-24).
- Active faith manifests through obedience, love, and sacrificial living, rejecting complacency and prioritizing God's kingdom (James 2:17, Luke 9:23).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Revelation 3:15-16 teach about God's view of lukewarm faith?**
   - It shows that lukewarmness is unacceptable to God, as it indicates a lack of true devotion.
2. **How does Matthew 22:37 challenge believers to avoid spiritual complacency?**
   - By commanding complete love and commitment to God in all aspects of life.
3. **What are practical signs of lukewarm faith?**
   - Lack of prayer, minimal engagement in God's Word, and prioritizing worldly pursuits over spiritual growth.
4. **How can believers reignite their passion for God?**
   - By repenting of complacency, seeking God's presence daily, and actively serving in His work.
5. **What role does community play in avoiding lukewarm faith?**
   - Fellow believers provide encouragement, accountability, and opportunities for growth.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Assess Your Heart**: Reflect on areas where lukewarmness may have crept in and seek God's guidance.
2. **Pursue Passionate Worship**: Dedicate time to worship, prayer, and studying God's Word.
3. **Engage Actively**: Commit to a ministry or outreach to actively live out your faith.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Ask God to reveal and remove areas of complacency in your faith.
2. Pray for a renewed passion for Him and His purposes.
3. Thank God for His patience and grace in drawing you closer to Him.

Sola Scriptura 2:34
Stewardship of Time, Talents, and Treasures

FOCUS: HONORING GOD THROUGH WISE MANAGEMENT OF HIS GIFTS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 25:14-30
- Colossians 3:23-24
- 2 Corinthians 9:7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Peter 4:10
- Ephesians 5:15-16
- Proverbs 3:9

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Stewardship involves recognizing that all resources—time, talents, and treasures—belong to God and should be used for His glory (Matthew 25:14-30, Proverbs 3:9).
- Faithful stewardship requires intentionality, cheerfulness, and excellence in managing what God has entrusted to us (2 Corinthians 9:7, Colossians 3:23-24).
- Believers are called to invest in God's kingdom through service, generosity, and wise use of their time (1 Peter 4:10, Ephesians 5:15-16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does the parable of the talents teach about stewardship?**
   - It emphasizes accountability and the importance of using God's gifts productively.
2. **How can believers honor God with their time (Ephesians 5:15-16)?**
   - By prioritizing activities that glorify God and align with His will.
3. **Why does God value cheerful giving (2 Corinthians 9:7)?**
   - Because it reflects trust in His provision and a heart aligned with His generosity.
4. **What are practical ways to steward your talents?**
   - Serve in church, volunteer in your community, or use your skills to mentor others.
5. **How can believers grow in managing their finances biblically?**
   - By budgeting wisely, giving generously, and avoiding debt.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Create a Stewardship Plan**: Assess your time, talents, and finances, and set goals for using them to glorify God.
2. **Serve Others**: Volunteer in a ministry or community project that aligns with your talents.
3. **Give Generously**: Commit to regular, joyful giving as an act of worship.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the resources He has entrusted to you.
2. Pray for wisdom and diligence in managing His gifts.
3. Ask for opportunities to serve and invest in His kingdom.

Sola Scriptura 2:35
Overcoming Anxiety Through Faith

FOCUS: TRUSTING GOD TO FIND PEACE AMID WORRIES AND FEARS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Philippians 4:6-7
- Matthew 6:25-34
- Psalm 55:22

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Peter 5:7
- Isaiah 26:3
- John 14:27

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Anxiety is a common human experience, but God invites believers to exchange their worries for His peace through prayer and trust (Philippians 4:6-7, Matthew 6:25-34).
- Trusting in God's sovereignty and provision provides a solid foundation for peace, even in uncertain circumstances (Isaiah 26:3, John 14:27).
- Casting cares on the Lord demonstrates faith in His care and ability to sustain us (Psalm 55:22, 1 Peter 5:7).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does Philippians 4:6-7 guide believers in handling anxiety?**

- By encouraging prayer, thanksgiving, and trust in God, leading to His peace.

2. **What assurance does Matthew 6:25-34 provide about God's provision?**
   - It reminds believers that God knows and meets their needs, freeing them from worry.
3. **What does it mean to cast your cares on the Lord (1 Peter 5:7)?**
   - It involves surrendering control and trusting God with your concerns.
4. **How can faith in God's sovereignty reduce anxiety?**
   - Knowing that God is in control brings confidence that He works all things for good.
5. **What practical steps can you take to overcome anxiety?**
   - Pray regularly, meditate on Scripture, and focus on God's promises.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Memorize Key Verses**: Choose a verse on peace to recite during anxious moments.
2. **Start a Prayer Journal**: Write down your worries and prayers, noting how God answers.
3. **Seek Community**: Share your concerns with trusted believers for encouragement and support.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His care and faithfulness.
2. Pray for His peace to guard your heart and mind.
3. Ask for trust and surrender in areas of worry.

Sola Scriptura 2:36

Giving an Accounting for Sin

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE REALITY OF JUDGMENT, THE CALL TO REPENTANCE, AND THE ASSURANCE OF FORGIVENESS THROUGH CHRIST.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 14:12
- Ecclesiastes 12:14
- Hebrews 9:27

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 12:36-37
- 2 Corinthians 5:10
- 1 John 1:9
- Acts 17:30-31

BIBLICAL TEACHING:

- Every person will one day give an account to God for their actions, words, and thoughts, demonstrating the seriousness of sin (Romans 14:12, Ecclesiastes 12:14).
- God's judgment is impartial and unavoidable, but repentance and faith in Christ provide forgiveness and reconciliation (Acts 17:30-31, 1 John 1:9).
- Believers are called to live with an eternal perspective, seeking to honor God in all they do and relying on His grace for their shortcomings (2 Corinthians 5:10, Matthew 12:36-37).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Romans 14:12 teach about personal accountability before God?**
   - Each individual is responsible for their own actions and will give an account directly to God.
2. **How does Ecclesiastes 12:14 emphasize the seriousness of judgment?**
   - It highlights that nothing is hidden from God, and all deeds—good and bad—will be judged.
3. **What assurance does 1 John 1:9 provide for those who repent?**
   - It assures forgiveness and cleansing from sin for those who confess and turn to God.
4. **How does the reality of judgment motivate repentance (Acts 17:30-31)?**
   - Knowing that God has set a day for judgment inspires humility and a desire to align with His will.
5. **What practical steps can believers take to prepare for giving an account?**
   - Regularly examine their hearts, confess sins, and seek to live faithfully in obedience to God.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Daily Self-Examination**: Spend time reflecting on your actions and words, asking God to reveal any unconfessed sin.
2. **Commit to Repentance**: Make confession and repentance a regular part of your prayer life.
3. **Share the Gospel**: Encourage others to turn to Christ by sharing the hope and forgiveness He offers.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His grace and forgiveness through Christ.
2. Ask Him to reveal any hidden sins in your life and help you turn from them.
3. Pray for boldness to share the reality of judgment and the hope of salvation with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:37
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on Salvation

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE KEY DIFFERENCES AND COMMONALITIES BETWEEN PROTESTANT AND ROMAN CATHOLIC BELIEFS ABOUT SALVATION.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:8-9
- Romans 3:28
- James 2:17

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- John 14:6
- Titus 3:5
- Philippians 2:12
- Hebrews 10:10

PROTESTANT VIEW ON SALVATION:

- **Sola Gratia (Grace Alone)**: Salvation is entirely a gift of God's grace, not earned by human merit or effort (Ephesians 2:8-9).
- **Sola Fide (Faith Alone)**: Justification comes through faith in Christ alone, apart from works (Romans 3:28).
- **Sanctification vs. Justification**: Justification is a one-time act of God declaring a sinner righteous, while sanctification is the ongoing process of becoming holy.

- **Authority of Scripture**: Protestants emphasize the authority of the Bible in defining salvation, rejecting any additions from tradition.

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON SALVATION:

- **Faith and Works**: Salvation is initiated by grace and faith but must be accompanied by works and sacraments (James 2:17, Philippians 2:12).
- **Sacraments**: Baptism, Eucharist, Confession, and other sacraments are seen as necessary means of receiving God's grace.
- **Justification as a Process**: Justification is not seen as a one-time declaration but as a process involving both God's grace and human cooperation.
- **Role of the Church**: The Roman Catholic Church is viewed as the mediator of God's grace through the sacraments and tradition.

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Basis of Justification**: Protestants emphasize justification by faith alone, while Catholics view it as faith plus works.
2. **Role of Sacraments**: Protestants see sacraments as symbolic acts of obedience, whereas Catholics believe they are essential channels of grace.
3. **Authority**: Protestants rely on Scripture alone, while Catholics include tradition and the Magisterium (Church teaching authority).
4. **Finality of Justification**: Protestants believe justification is a one-time event; Catholics see it as an ongoing process.

COMMON GROUND:

- Both affirm that salvation is by God's grace and made possible through Christ's atoning work.

- Both emphasize the necessity of faith and repentance.
- Both seek to live in obedience to Christ as a response to God's grace.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Ephesians 2:8-9 teach about the nature of salvation?**
   - Salvation is a gift of grace, not earned by works, highlighting God's mercy.
2. **How do Protestants interpret James 2:17?**
   - Genuine faith naturally produces works, but works are not the basis of justification.
3. **What role do sacraments play in the Roman Catholic view of salvation?**
   - Sacraments are seen as necessary means by which grace is received.
4. **How do the two views understand the concept of assurance of salvation?**
   - Protestants often believe in assurance through faith in Christ, while Catholics may view assurance as tied to perseverance in faith and works.
5. **Why is it important to understand these differences?**
   - It fosters meaningful dialogue, mutual respect, and deeper personal understanding of one's own beliefs.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study the Scriptures**: Reflect on key passages about salvation to clarify your understanding of God's grace.
2. **Engage in Dialogue**: Discuss these views respectfully with someone from a different tradition to learn from one another.

3. **Live Out Your Faith**: Focus on expressing gratitude for God's grace through faith, obedience, and love.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His gift of salvation through Christ.
2. Pray for wisdom to understand His Word and live faithfully.
3. Ask for humility and grace in discussing these topics with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:38
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on the Authority of Scripture

FOCUS: EXAMINING THE SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES BETWEEN PROTESTANT AND ROMAN CATHOLIC BELIEFS ABOUT THE AUTHORITY OF SCRIPTURE IN THE CHRISTIAN LIFE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Timothy 3:16-17
- Matthew 15:6
- Isaiah 40:8

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- John 10:35
- Psalm 119:105
- Acts 17:11
- Revelation 22:18-19

PROTESTANT VIEW ON THE AUTHORITY OF SCRIPTURE:

- **Sola Scriptura (Scripture Alone)**: The Bible is the ultimate and sole authority for faith and practice, sufficient for teaching, correcting, and guiding believers (2 Timothy 3:16-17).

- **Rejection of Equal Authorities**: Protestantism rejects the authority of church traditions and councils when they conflict with Scripture (Matthew 15:6).
- **Individual Responsibility**: Believers are encouraged to read and interpret Scripture for themselves, guided by the Holy Spirit (Acts 17:11).

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON THE AUTHORITY OF SCRIPTURE:

- **Scripture and Tradition**: Scripture and Sacred Tradition are seen as complementary sources of divine revelation, both holding equal authority (2 Thessalonians 2:15).
- **Role of the Magisterium**: The teaching authority of the Church (the Magisterium) is entrusted with interpreting Scripture and Tradition (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 85-87).
- **Preservation of the Canon**: The Catholic Church sees itself as the custodian of the Scriptures, preserving and defining the biblical canon.

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Sola Scriptura vs. Scripture and Tradition**: Protestants affirm Scripture alone as the sole authority, while Catholics uphold both Scripture and Tradition as authoritative.
2. **Role of Interpretation**: Protestants emphasize individual interpretation under the Holy Spirit, whereas Catholics believe the Magisterium provides the definitive interpretation of Scripture.
3. **Canon of Scripture**: The Protestant Bible contains 66 books, while the Catholic Bible includes 73 books, adding the Deuterocanonical books (e.g., Tobit, Wisdom, Maccabees).

COMMON GROUND:

- Both affirm Scripture as divinely inspired and authoritative in the life of the Church.
- Both agree that God's Word reveals His plan for salvation and is vital for teaching and correction.
- Both emphasize the importance of reverence for Scripture and its role in worship and doctrine.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 2 Timothy 3:16-17 teach about the role of Scripture?**
   - Scripture is God-breathed and sufficient for teaching, correcting, and training in righteousness.
2. **How does Matthew 15:6 caution against the misuse of tradition?**
   - It warns against elevating human tradition above God's Word.
3. **What is the role of the Magisterium in Catholic belief?**
   - The Magisterium serves as the official interpreter of Scripture and Tradition.
4. **How does the Protestant view of Sola Scriptura empower individual believers?**
   - It encourages personal study and reliance on the Holy Spirit for understanding Scripture.
5. **Why is it important to understand these differences?**
   - Understanding fosters mutual respect and clarity in discussions about faith and authority.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Scripture Deeply**: Spend time reflecting on key passages about the authority and role of God's Word.
2. **Engage in Dialogue**: Discuss these views respectfully with someone from a different tradition to deepen understanding.
3. **Submit to God's Word**: Ensure your beliefs and practices align with Scripture's teachings.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of His Word as a guide and authority in your life.
2. Pray for discernment and understanding as you study Scripture.
3. Ask for humility and grace in discussing these differences with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:39
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on Heaven and Hell

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES IN PROTESTANT AND ROMAN CATHOLIC BELIEFS ABOUT THE AFTERLIFE, INCLUDING HEAVEN, HELL, AND PURGATORY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- John 14:2-3
- Matthew 25:46
- Revelation 20:14-15

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Corinthians 5:8
- Hebrews 9:27
- Luke 16:19-31
- Matthew 12:32

PROTESTANT VIEW ON HEAVEN AND HELL:

- Heaven: A place of eternal communion with God for believers, immediately entered upon death for those in Christ (John 14:2-3, 2 Corinthians 5:8).
- Hell: A place of eternal separation from God, reserved for those who reject Christ (Matthew 25:46, Revelation 20:14-15).
- No Purgatory: Protestants reject purgatory, believing that Christ's sacrifice is fully sufficient for salvation and that believers are made righteous through faith alone (Hebrews 9:27).

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON HEAVEN AND HELL:

- **Heaven**: The ultimate goal, where believers experience eternal communion with God, often after a period of purification (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 1024).
- **Hell**: Eternal separation from God for those who die in a state of mortal sin, emphasizing God's justice and respect for human free will (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 1035).
- **Purgatory**: A temporary state of purification for believers who die in God's grace but still need to be cleansed of venial sins or temporal punishment for sin before entering heaven (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 1030-1031, Matthew 12:32).

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Purgatory**: Protestants reject purgatory, while Catholics see it as a necessary purification process for some believers.
2. **Immediate Presence with God**: Protestants typically believe believers are immediately in God's presence after death, while Catholics may include purgatory as a step before heaven.
3. **Role of Works**: Protestant views emphasize salvation by grace through faith alone, while Catholic teaching incorporates the necessity of purification and merit as part of sanctification.

COMMON GROUND:

- Both affirm the reality of heaven as eternal communion with God and hell as eternal separation from Him.
- Both acknowledge the finality of judgment after death and the necessity of salvation through Christ.
- Both agree on the importance of living a holy life in preparation for eternity.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does John 14:2-3 teach about heaven?**
   - Jesus promises a prepared place in heaven for those who follow Him, offering assurance of eternal life.
2. **How do Protestants and Catholics interpret Matthew 12:32 differently?**
   - Catholics see it as evidence for purgatory, while Protestants often view it as a figure of speech or unrelated to purification after death.
3. **What does Revelation 20:14-15 say about the finality of hell?**
   - It emphasizes the eternal consequences of rejecting Christ, describing hell as the lake of fire.
4. **Why do Protestants reject purgatory?**
   - Protestants believe Christ's sacrifice fully atones for sin, leaving no need for additional purification.
5. **How can believers live with confidence about their eternal destiny?**
   - By trusting in Christ's finished work on the cross and living in obedience to His Word.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Scripture**: Reflect on key passages about heaven, hell, and eternal life to deepen your understanding of God's promises.
2. **Live with Eternity in Mind**: Evaluate your daily choices in light of eternal priorities.
3. **Share the Gospel**: Use this topic to encourage others to seek salvation in Christ.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the assurance of eternal life through Jesus Christ.
2. Pray for wisdom and understanding in navigating differing views with love and respect.
3. Ask for boldness in sharing the hope of heaven and the reality of God's justice.

Sola Scriptura 2:40
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on the Resurrection

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE COMMONALITIES AND DIFFERENCES BETWEEN PROTESTANT AND ROMAN CATHOLIC BELIEFS ABOUT THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS CHRIST AND THE FUTURE RESURRECTION OF BELIEVERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Corinthians 15:12-22
- John 11:25-26
- Philippians 3:20-21

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17
- Romans 8:11
- John 5:28-29
- Revelation 20:6

PROTESTANT VIEW ON THE RESURRECTION:

1. **Christ's Resurrection**: Central to the faith, proving Jesus' divinity, defeating sin and death, and securing salvation (1 Corinthians 15:12-22).
2. **Future Resurrection**: Believers will experience a bodily resurrection at Christ's second coming, receiving glorified bodies like His (Philippians 3:20-21, 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17).

3. **Final Judgment**: All people will be raised, some to eternal life and others to judgment, emphasizing personal accountability (John 5:28-29).
4. **Authority of Scripture**: The Bible is the sole source of doctrine about the resurrection, rejecting additional traditions.

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON THE RESURRECTION:

1. **Christ's Resurrection**: A core belief, celebrated especially during Easter, signifying the triumph of life over death and the foundation of Christian hope (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 638-655).
2. **Future Resurrection**: Catholic teaching also affirms a bodily resurrection for all people, with the righteous receiving glorified bodies and the wicked facing eternal separation (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 997-1001).
3. **Purgatory and Resurrection**: Catholics view the resurrection as the culmination of a process that may include purification in purgatory for some believers (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 1030-1031).
4. **Tradition and Magisterium**: Sacred Tradition and the Church's Magisterium provide additional insights and interpretations of the resurrection alongside Scripture.

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Role of Purgatory**: Protestants do not include purgatory in the journey to resurrection, while Catholics see it as a possible intermediary step before glorification.
2. **Authority**: Protestants rely solely on Scripture for resurrection doctrine, while Catholics incorporate Tradition and Church teaching.
3. **Interpretation of Resurrection Timing**: While both affirm a bodily resurrection, Catholics may emphasize its connection to the Eucharist and ongoing sanctification more explicitly.

COMMON GROUND:

- Both affirm the physical resurrection of Jesus Christ as the cornerstone of the Christian faith.
- Both believe in a future bodily resurrection for all people, leading to eternal life for the righteous.
- Both view the resurrection as a demonstration of God's power and the fulfillment of His redemptive plan.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why is Christ's resurrection essential to Christian faith (1 Corinthians 15:12-22)?**
   - It validates Jesus' victory over sin and death, guarantees believers' resurrection, and serves as the foundation for hope.
2. **What does Philippians 3:20-21 teach about the nature of believers' resurrection bodies?**
   - Believers' bodies will be transformed to be like Christ's glorious, imperishable body.
3. **How do Catholics and Protestants differ in their view of the resurrection process?**
   - Protestants view it as immediate glorification at Christ's return, while Catholics may include purgatory as part of the journey.
4. **What does John 5:28-29 reveal about the universal scope of the resurrection?**
   - All people, righteous and unrighteous, will be raised and face judgment.
5. **Why is the resurrection a source of hope for believers?**
   - It assures eternal life, the renewal of creation, and victory over sin and death through Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Live with Resurrection Hope**: Reflect daily on the promise of eternal life and how it impacts your priorities.
2. **Study Scripture Together**: Explore resurrection passages with others to deepen your understanding of its significance.
3. **Share the Gospel**: Use the resurrection as a foundation for sharing the hope of salvation with others.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the victory over sin and death through Christ's resurrection.
2. Pray for confidence in His promise of eternal life and for strength to live faithfully in light of it.
3. Ask for grace and wisdom in discussing differing views of the resurrection with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:41
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on Saints

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE DIFFERING BELIEFS AND PRACTICES REGARDING SAINTS IN PROTESTANTISM AND ROMAN CATHOLICISM.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Timothy 2:5
- Hebrews 12:1
- 1 Corinthians 1:2

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Exodus 20:4-5
- Revelation 5:8
- Philippians 3:20-21
- Psalm 115:4-8

PROTESTANT VIEW ON SAINTS:

1. **Definition of Saints**: All believers are considered saints, as they are sanctified by faith in Christ (1 Corinthians 1:2).
2. **No Intercession by Saints**: Protestants reject the practice of praying to or through saints, emphasizing Christ as the sole mediator between God and humanity (1 Timothy 2:5).
3. **Rejection of Veneration**: Saints are respected as examples of faith, but Protestants do not venerate or attribute special spiritual powers to them.

4. **Focus on Christ**: Protestants emphasize a direct relationship with God through Jesus without intermediaries, relying solely on His work for salvation.

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON SAINTS:

1. **Definition of Saints**: Saints are believers who lived exceptionally holy lives and are canonized by the Church, recognized as being in heaven (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 828).
2. **Intercession of Saints**: Catholics believe saints can intercede for believers, presenting prayers to God on their behalf (Revelation 5:8).
3. **Veneration vs. Worship**: Saints are venerated, not worshiped. Veneration involves honoring their example and seeking their intercession while worship is reserved for God alone.
4. **Role of Saints**: Saints serve as models of faith, encouragement for the living, and participants in the communion of saints (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 956-957).

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Definition of Saints**: Protestants see all believers as saints, while Catholics reserve the title for canonized individuals.
2. **Prayer to Saints**: Protestants reject praying to saints, while Catholics see it as seeking intercession from those close to God.
3. **Veneration**: Protestants reject veneration as potentially idolatrous, while Catholics distinguish it from worship and see it as honoring God's work in the saints.
4. **Role in Salvation**: Protestants emphasize Christ as the sole mediator, while Catholics believe saints can assist through their intercessory prayers.

COMMON GROUND:

- Both traditions recognize the value of the lives of faithful believers as examples to inspire others.
- Both affirm that only God is worthy of worship and ultimate devotion.
- Both agree on the reality of a heavenly communion of believers who have gone before us (Hebrews 12:1).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 Timothy 2:5 teach about mediation?**
   - It establishes Christ as the only mediator between God and humanity, eliminating the need for other intercessors.
2. **How do Protestants interpret the term "saints" (1 Corinthians 1:2)?**
   - Protestants understand all believers to be saints, sanctified by their faith in Christ.
3. **What is the Catholic understanding of praying to saints?**
   - It is seen as asking saints to intercede with God on behalf of the living, much like asking a friend to pray for you.
4. **Why do Protestants reject veneration of saints?**
   - Protestants see it as potentially detracting from Christ's unique role and risking idolatry.
5. **What is the purpose of honoring saints in Catholic tradition?**
   - It serves to glorify God for His work in their lives and to inspire believers to live holy lives.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Biblical Saints**: Reflect on the lives of biblical figures described as saints and how their faith inspires your walk with God.

2. **Focus on Christ**: Reaffirm Christ's unique role as the sole mediator and your personal connection to Him.
3. **Foster Respectful Dialogue**: Engage with others from differing traditions to understand their practices and share your faith.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the examples of faith provided by past believers.
2. Pray for wisdom in understanding differing views with humility and grace.
3. Ask for the strength to live a life that points others to Christ.

Sola Scriptura 2:42
Comparing Protestant and Roman Catholic Views on the Role of Mary

FOCUS: EXAMINING THE DIFFERENT BELIEFS AND PRACTICES SURROUNDING MARY, THE MOTHER OF JESUS, IN PROTESTANTISM AND ROMAN CATHOLICISM.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Luke 1:28
- Luke 1:46-48
- John 2:5

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 1:23
- Luke 2:34-35
- Acts 1:14
- Exodus 20:3-4

PROTESTANT VIEW ON MARY:

1. **Highly Honored but Not Venerated**: Mary is respected as the mother of Jesus and an example of faith, humility, and obedience (Luke 1:46-48).
2. **No Intercession or Mediation**: Protestants do not pray to Mary or see her as an intercessor, emphasizing Christ as the sole mediator (1 Timothy 2:5).
3. **Focus on Jesus**: Mary is seen as pointing to Christ, not as a focus of devotion (John 2:5).

4. **No Immaculate Conception or Assumption**: Protestants generally reject the doctrines of Mary's sinless conception and bodily assumption into heaven, as they are not explicitly taught in Scripture.

ROMAN CATHOLIC VIEW ON MARY:

1. **Veneration (Hyperdulia)**: Catholics venerate Mary, distinguishing this from worship (latria), which is reserved for God alone (Luke 1:48).
2. **Intercession**: Mary is seen as an intercessor who brings prayers to Christ, based on her role as Jesus' mother and her closeness to Him (John 2:5).
3. **Doctrines of Mary**:
   - **Immaculate Conception**: Mary was conceived without original sin to be a pure vessel for Christ (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 491).
   - **Perpetual Virginity**: Mary remained a virgin before, during, and after Jesus' birth (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 499).
   - **Assumption**: Mary was assumed body and soul into heaven at the end of her earthly life (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 966).
4. **Titles**: Mary is given titles such as "Mother of God" (Theotokos), "Queen of Heaven," and "Mother of the Church" (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 963-970).

KEY DIFFERENCES:

1. **Veneration vs. Honor**: Catholics venerate Mary as uniquely favored by God, while Protestants honor her without veneration.
2. **Doctrines About Mary**: Protestants reject Catholic teachings such as the Immaculate Conception, perpetual virginity, and assumption, viewing them as extra-biblical.

3. **Role as Intercessor**: Catholics see Mary as an intercessor, while Protestants emphasize direct prayer to Christ alone.
4. **Titles and Devotion**: Protestants focus on Mary's biblical role, whereas Catholics include additional titles and forms of devotion based on tradition and Church teachings.

COMMON GROUND:

- Both traditions affirm Mary as the mother of Jesus, chosen by God for a unique role in salvation history.
- Both acknowledge her faith and obedience as an example for all believers.
- Both agree that Mary points to Christ and should not be worshiped as divine.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Luke 1:46-48 teach about Mary's role and significance?**
   - Mary is to be called blessed for her faith and role in God's plan, yet she glorifies God, not herself.
2. **How do Protestants and Catholics interpret John 2:5 differently?**
   - Protestants see it as Mary directing attention to Jesus, while Catholics view it as evidence of her intercessory role.
3. **Why do Protestants reject the doctrines of the Immaculate Conception and Assumption?**
   - These doctrines are not explicitly taught in Scripture and are seen as additions to biblical revelation.
4. **What does the Catholic Church mean by "veneration" of Mary?**
   - Veneration honors Mary's unique role without equating it to worship, which is reserved for God.

5. **How can Mary's example inspire believers in both traditions?**
   - Her faith, humility, and willingness to submit to God's will serve as a model for all Christians.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Mary's Story**: Reflect on key biblical passages about Mary and how her faith shaped her role in God's plan.
2. **Focus on Christ**: Follow Mary's example of pointing others to Jesus and glorifying God.
3. **Engage in Dialogue**: Respectfully discuss the differing views on Mary with others, seeking to understand and share biblical truths.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for Mary's example of faith and obedience
2. Pray for wisdom and humility in understanding differing views about Mary.
3. Ask for strength to follow Mary's example of submitting to God's will in your own life.

Sola Scriptura 2:43

Refuting Mormonism

FOCUS: EXAMINING KEY BELIEFS OF MORMONISM (THE CHURCH OF JESUS CHRIST OF LATTER-DAY SAINTS) IN LIGHT OF BIBLICAL DOCTRINE TO PROVIDE A CLEAR, CHRIST-CENTERED RESPONSE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- John 1:1-3, 14
- Galatians 1:6-8
- Ephesians 2:8-9

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Deuteronomy 4:2
- Hebrews 9:27
- Matthew 24:24
- Isaiah 43:10

KEY BELIEFS OF MORMONISM AND BIBLICAL RESPONSES:

1. **Nature of God**:
    - **Mormonism**: Teaches that God the Father was once a man and progressed to godhood, and humans can also become gods.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **Isaiah 43:10**: God declares that no god existed before Him, nor will there be any after Him.

        - **Malachi 3:6**: God is unchanging, eternal, and unique.

2. **Jesus Christ**:
    - **Mormonism**: Believes Jesus is a created being and the spirit brother of Lucifer.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **John 1:1-3**: Jesus is eternal, uncreated, and fully God.
        - **Colossians 1:15-17**: Jesus is the Creator of all things, not a created being.
3. **Authority of Scripture**:
    - **Mormonism**: Accepts the Book of Mormon, Doctrine and Covenants, and Pearl of Great Price as additional scripture alongside the Bible.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **Deuteronomy 4:2** and **Revelation 22:18-19**: Warn against adding to God's revealed Word.
        - **2 Timothy 3:16-17**: Scripture is sufficient for teaching, correction, and training in righteousness.
4. **Salvation**:
    - **Mormonism**: Teaches a works-based salvation, including baptism for the dead and temple rituals.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **Ephesians 2:8-9**: Salvation is by grace through faith, not by works.
        - **Hebrews 9:27**: There is no second chance for salvation after death.

5. **Prophets and Revelation**:
    - **Mormonism**: Believes Joseph Smith was a prophet and that modern prophets continue to receive revelation.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **Galatians 1:6-8**: Warns against "another gospel" even if it comes from an angel.
        - **Hebrews 1:1-2**: God's ultimate revelation is through His Son, Jesus Christ.

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS AND CLARIFICATIONS:

- **Shared Terms**: Mormons use Christian terms like "God," "Jesus," and "salvation," but with different definitions. Clarify these terms using Scripture.
- **Kindness in Dialogue**: While refuting false doctrine, approach Mormons with love and respect, seeking to point them to the biblical Jesus.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does the Bible say about the nature of God compared to Mormon teaching?**

- God is eternal, unchanging, and the only God (Isaiah 43:10). He was never a man who progressed to godhood.

2. **How does John 1:1-3 refute the Mormon view of Jesus as a created being?**

- John declares Jesus as eternal and divine, co-existing with God from the beginning and responsible for all creation.

3. **Why is the Bible sufficient, and how does this refute Mormon scripture?**

- **2 Timothy 3:16-17** teaches that Scripture is sufficient for all matters of faith and practice, making additional revelations unnecessary.

4. **What does the Bible teach about salvation compared to Mormonism's works-based view?**

- Salvation is a free gift of grace through faith in Christ, not dependent on human works or rituals (Ephesians 2:8-9).

5. **How can believers engage Mormons in meaningful dialogue?**

- By focusing on the sufficiency of Christ's work, the authority of Scripture, and using questions to encourage reflection.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Key Scriptures**: Familiarize yourself with passages that address God's nature, salvation, and the sufficiency of Scripture.
2. **Engage with Kindness**: Approach conversations with humility, listening carefully while gently pointing to biblical truth.
3. **Pray for Discernment**: Ask God for wisdom in presenting the gospel clearly to Mormons.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His revealed truth in Scripture and the finished work of Christ.
2. Pray for opportunities to share the gospel with Mormons and for their hearts to be open to biblical truth.
3. Ask for courage and clarity when engaging in discussions about faith.

Sola Scriptura 2:44

Refuting Jehovah's Witnesses

FOCUS: EXAMINING THE BELIEFS OF JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES IN LIGHT OF BIBLICAL TRUTH AND PROVIDING A CHRIST-CENTERED RESPONSE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- John 1:1-3, 14
- Colossians 1:15-17
- John 14:6

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Isaiah 43:10-11
- Hebrews 1:3
- Titus 2:13
- Revelation 22:13

KEY BELIEFS OF JEHOVAH'S WITNESSES AND BIBLICAL RESPONSES:

1. **The Deity of Jesus Christ**:
   - **Jehovah's Witnesses**: Teach that Jesus is a created being, the archangel Michael, and not God.
   - **Biblical Response**:
     - **John 1:1-3, 14**: Jesus is eternal, uncreated, and fully God.
     - **Colossians 1:15-17**: Jesus is not part of creation but the Creator of all things.
     - **Titus 2:13**: Refers to Jesus as "our great God and Savior."

2. **The Holy Trinity**:
   - **Jehovah's Witnesses**: Deny the doctrine of the Trinity, teaching that only Jehovah (the Father) is God.
   - **Biblical Response**:
     - **Matthew 28:19**: The Father, Son, and Holy Spirit are co-equal and co-eternal, revealed in the baptismal formula.
     - **John 10:30**: Jesus states, "I and the Father are one," affirming His divine nature.
     - **Hebrews 1:3**: The Son shares the exact nature of God.
3. **Salvation by Works**:
   - **Jehovah's Witnesses**: Believe salvation depends on faith, works, and active membership in the Watchtower organization.
   - **Biblical Response**:
     - **Ephesians 2:8-9**: Salvation is by grace through faith, not by works.
     - **Titus 3:5**: God saves us through His mercy, not because of righteous acts.
     - **Romans 10:9**: Confessing Jesus as Lord and believing in His resurrection brings salvation.
4. **Jesus' Resurrection**:
   - **Jehovah's Witnesses**: Claim Jesus was resurrected as a spirit being, not bodily.
   - **Biblical Response**:
     - **Luke 24:39**: Jesus says, "Touch Me and see; a ghost does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have."
     - **John 20:27**: Jesus invites Thomas to touch His wounds, proving His bodily resurrection.
     - **1 Corinthians 15:3-8**: Paul affirms the physical resurrection of Jesus.

5. **Hell and Eternal Punishment**:
    - **Jehovah's Witnesses**: Deny the existence of hell, teaching that the wicked are annihilated.
    - **Biblical Response**:
        - **Matthew 25:46**: Jesus speaks of eternal punishment for the wicked and eternal life for the righteous.
        - **Revelation 20:10**: The lake of fire is described as eternal torment.
        - **Mark 9:43-48**: Jesus warns about hell as a place where "the fire never goes out."

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS AND CLARIFICATIONS:

- **Jesus as "Firstborn"**: Jehovah's Witnesses interpret "firstborn" in Colossians 1:15 as "created," but biblically it refers to preeminence and rank.
- **Bible Translation**: The New World Translation (used by Jehovah's Witnesses) alters key texts, such as John 1:1, to fit their theology. Use multiple Bible translations to clarify meanings.
- **Respectful Dialogue**: Engage Jehovah's Witnesses with kindness, asking thoughtful questions that encourage them to examine Scripture.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does John 1:1-3 reveal about Jesus' divine nature?**
    - It identifies Jesus as eternal, coexistent with God, and Himself God, refuting the idea that He is a created being.
2. **Why is the Trinity essential to Christian doctrine?**
    - It reflects the biblical revelation of God's nature as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, co-equal and co-eternal (Matthew 28:19).

3. **How does the Bible affirm the bodily resurrection of Jesus?**
   - Jesus' physical appearances after His resurrection (Luke 24:39, John 20:27) prove He was raised bodily, not as a spirit.
4. **What is the biblical teaching on salvation compared to works-based salvation?**
   - Salvation is a gift of grace received through faith, not earned by human effort (Ephesians 2:8-9).
5. **Why is hell described as eternal in the Bible?**
   - Jesus and the apostles consistently teach about hell as eternal punishment, contrasting it with eternal life (Matthew 25:46).

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Key Scriptures**: Memorize verses that affirm Jesus' divinity, the Trinity, and the gospel of grace.
2. **Engage in Dialogue**: Use respectful questions to challenge Jehovah's Witnesses to consider the full context of Scripture.
3. **Pray for Discernment**: Ask God for wisdom in refuting false teachings and sharing the gospel effectively.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for revealing His truth through Scripture and the work of Christ.
2. Pray for opportunities to share the gospel with Jehovah's Witnesses and for their hearts to be open to the biblical Jesus.
3. Ask for courage, humility, and clarity in discussing theological differences.

Sola Scriptura 2:45
Understanding the Lord's Supper and Its Significance

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE BIBLICAL MEANING, PURPOSE, AND PRACTICE OF THE LORD'S SUPPER (COMMUNION) AND ITS ROLE IN THE LIFE OF THE CHURCH.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Luke 22:19-20
- 1 Corinthians 11:23-26
- Matthew 26:26-28

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- John 6:53-56
- Exodus 12:11-14
- Hebrews 9:14-15
- Acts 2:42

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON THE LORD'S SUPPER:

1. **Instituted by Jesus**: The Lord's Supper was established by Christ during the Last Supper, linking it to His sacrifice on the cross (Luke 22:19-20).
2. **A New Covenant**: The bread and wine symbolize Christ's body and blood, representing the new covenant through His atoning death (1 Corinthians 11:25, Hebrews 9:14-15).

3. **A Memorial Act**: Communion is done in remembrance of Jesus, recalling His sacrifice and proclaiming His death until He returns (1 Corinthians 11:26).
4. **A Spiritual Participation**: Believers spiritually commune with Christ, receiving grace and strength as they partake (John 6:53-56).
5. **A Sign of Unity**: The Lord's Supper unites believers as one body in Christ, reflecting their shared faith and fellowship (1 Corinthians 10:16-17).

WHY THE LORD'S SUPPER MATTERS:

- **Remembrance**: It keeps the focus on Christ's sacrifice, fostering gratitude and worship (Luke 22:19).
- **Proclamation**: It declares the gospel, reminding believers and witnessing to others of Jesus' death and resurrection (1 Corinthians 11:26).
- **Examination**: It encourages self-reflection and repentance, fostering spiritual growth and purity (1 Corinthians 11:27-29).
- **Anticipation**: It points forward to Christ's return, cultivating hope and perseverance (Matthew 26:29).

KEY SYMBOLISM:

1. **Bread**: Represents Christ's body, broken for the redemption of humanity (Luke 22:19).
2. **Wine**: Symbolizes Christ's blood, shed for the forgiveness of sins and sealing the new covenant (Matthew 26:28).
3. **Unity of the Table**: Sharing the elements signifies the unity of believers in Christ (1 Corinthians 10:16-17).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Luke 22:19-20 teach about the purpose of the Lord's Supper?**
   - It is an act of remembrance and gratitude for Jesus' sacrifice, sealing the new covenant.
2. **Why is self-examination important before participating in Communion (1 Corinthians 11:27-29)?**
   - To approach the Lord's Supper with reverence, repentance, and faith, avoiding unworthy participation.
3. **How does the Lord's Supper proclaim the gospel (1 Corinthians 11:26)?**
   - It visibly demonstrates Jesus' sacrifice, reminding believers and proclaiming His death until He comes.
4. **What does John 6:53-56 mean when it speaks of eating Christ's flesh and drinking His blood?**
   - It emphasizes the necessity of spiritually partaking in Christ through faith for eternal life, symbolized in Communion.
5. **How does the Lord's Supper foster unity among believers?**
   - By sharing in the same bread and cup, believers affirm their shared faith and identity in Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Prepare Your Heart**: Before participating in the Lord's Supper, spend time in prayer, confession, and reflection.
2. **Celebrate Regularly**: Participate in Communion as an act of worship and remembrance of Christ's sacrifice.
3. **Share the Gospel**: Use the Lord's Supper as an opportunity to explain the significance of Jesus' death and resurrection to others.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of Jesus' sacrifice and the new covenant sealed by His blood.
2. Pray for a deeper understanding of the Lord's Supper and its meaning in your life.
3. Ask for unity and fellowship among believers as you partake together.

Sola Scriptura 2:46
The Passover and Its Fulfillment in Christ

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE CONNECTION BETWEEN THE OLD TESTAMENT PASSOVER AND ITS FULFILLMENT IN JESUS CHRIST, THE LAMB OF GOD.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Exodus 12:1-14
- John 1:29
- 1 Corinthians 5:7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Hebrews 10:1-10
- Isaiah 53:7
- Revelation 5:12
- Matthew 26:26-28

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON THE PASSOVER AND CHRIST:

1. **The First Passover**: The Passover was instituted to commemorate Israel's deliverance from slavery in Egypt. The lamb's blood on the doorposts saved the Israelites from the final plague (Exodus 12:1-14).
2. **Jesus as the Passover Lamb**: Jesus fulfills the Passover by being the perfect Lamb of God, whose sacrifice delivers believers from sin and death (John 1:29, 1 Corinthians 5:7).

3. **From Shadow to Substance**: The Old Testament Passover foreshadowed the ultimate redemption through Christ, whose blood establishes the new covenant (Hebrews 10:1-10).
4. **A New Exodus**: Just as the Israelites were delivered from Egypt, Christ's sacrifice brings spiritual deliverance from sin, death, and separation from God (Isaiah 53:7).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What was the purpose of the Passover lamb (Exodus 12:13)?**
   - The lamb's blood marked the Israelites as God's people, sparing them from judgment.
2. **How does John 1:29 connect Jesus to the Passover lamb?**
   - John identifies Jesus as the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world, fulfilling the Passover's significance.
3. **What does 1 Corinthians 5:7 mean by calling Christ "our Passover lamb"?**
   - It affirms that Jesus' sacrifice accomplishes the ultimate deliverance from sin and judgment.
4. **How does the Passover meal relate to the Lord's Supper (Matthew 26:26-28)?**
   - Jesus transformed the Passover meal into a new covenant celebration, pointing to His sacrifice.
5. **Why is it important to understand the connection between the Passover and Christ?**
   - It deepens our appreciation for God's redemptive plan and the significance of Jesus' sacrifice.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on Redemption**: Consider how Christ has delivered you from sin, just as God delivered Israel from Egypt.
2. **Study Old Testament Foreshadows**: Explore how the Passover points to Jesus as the ultimate Lamb of God.
3. **Celebrate the Lord's Supper**: Remember and proclaim Christ's sacrifice, connecting it to the fulfillment of the Passover.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His perfect plan of redemption through Christ, the Passover Lamb.
2. Pray for a deeper understanding of how the Old and New Testaments connect.
3. Ask for gratitude and humility as you reflect on Christ's sacrifice.

Sola Scriptura 2:47

The New Covenant Explained

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE PROMISES OF THE NEW COVENANT AND ITS SIGNIFICANCE FOR BELIEVERS TODAY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Jeremiah 31:31-34
- Luke 22:20
- Hebrews 8:6-13

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ezekiel 36:26-27
- 2 Corinthians 3:6
- Matthew 26:28
- Romans 8:1-4

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON THE NEW COVENANT:

1. **God's Promise**: The new covenant, prophesied in Jeremiah 31:31-34, replaces the old covenant by writing God's law on hearts instead of stone tablets.
2. **Christ as the Mediator**: Jesus' sacrifice establishes the new covenant, offering forgiveness of sins and reconciliation with God (Hebrews 8:6-13, Luke 22:20).
3. **Internal Transformation**: The new covenant emphasizes an internal change through the Holy Spirit, enabling believers to live in obedience (Ezekiel 36:26-27).

4. **Fulfillment of the Old Covenant**: The old covenant's sacrifices foreshadowed the perfect sacrifice of Jesus, which fulfilled the requirements of the law (Hebrews 10:1-10).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Jeremiah 31:31-34 teach about the new covenant?**
   - It promises a covenant based on internal transformation, personal knowledge of God, and complete forgiveness of sins.
2. **How does Luke 22:20 connect the new covenant to Jesus?**
   - Jesus establishes the new covenant through His blood, which brings forgiveness and restores the relationship between God and humanity.
3. **What is the role of the Holy Spirit in the new covenant (Ezekiel 36:26-27)?**
   - The Spirit enables believers to live according to God's will, transforming their hearts and empowering obedience.
4. **How does the new covenant surpass the old covenant (Hebrews 8:6-13)?**
   - It is based on better promises, offering eternal forgiveness and a personal relationship with God.
5. **Why is the new covenant essential for understanding salvation?**
   - It reveals God's ultimate plan for redemption, centered on grace, faith, and the work of Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Embrace the New Covenant**: Trust in Christ's finished work as the basis of your relationship with God.
2. **Live by the Spirit**: Seek the Spirit's guidance in living according to God's will.

3. **Share the Gospel**: Explain the hope and promises of the new covenant to others.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the new covenant and the forgiveness of sins through Jesus.
2. Pray for a transformed heart and mind, empowered by the Holy Spirit.
3. Ask for opportunities to share the message of the new covenant with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:48

What It Means to Walk with Christ

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE BIBLICAL DEFINITION OF WALKING WITH CHRIST AND ITS PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS FOR DAILY LIFE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Micah 6:8
- John 15:5
- Colossians 2:6-7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 5:16
- Ephesians 5:1-2
- Psalm 119:105
- 1 John 2:6

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON WALKING WITH CHRIST:

1. **Relationship and Dependence**: Walking with Christ involves a daily, ongoing relationship with Him, relying on His strength and guidance (John 15:5).
2. **Living by Faith**: It means trusting Christ's promises and submitting to His lordship in every aspect of life (Colossians 2:6-7).
3. **Obedience and Holiness**: Walking with Christ requires living according to God's Word, empowered by the Holy Spirit (Psalm 119:105, Galatians 5:16).

4. **Love and Service**: Following Christ's example includes walking in love, demonstrating compassion, humility, and selflessness (Ephesians 5:1-2, Micah 6:8).
5. **Transformation**: Walking with Christ results in spiritual growth, bearing fruit, and becoming more like Him (1 John 2:6).

PRACTICAL WAYS TO WALK WITH CHRIST:

1. **Abide in His Word**: Regularly read and meditate on Scripture for guidance and encouragement (Psalm 119:105).
2. **Prayer and Communion**: Maintain an active prayer life to stay connected with Christ (Philippians 4:6-7).
3. **Obey His Commands**: Live in obedience to God's will as revealed in His Word (John 14:15).
4. **Rely on the Spirit**: Walk by the Spirit, seeking His empowerment to overcome sin and bear fruit (Galatians 5:16, 22-23).
5. **Serve Others**: Follow Christ's example by loving and serving those around you (Ephesians 5:1-2, John 13:14-15).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Micah 6:8 teach about walking with God?**
   - It highlights humility, justice, and mercy as essential aspects of walking with Christ.
2. **How does John 15:5 describe our dependence on Christ?**
   - It shows that remaining connected to Christ is the source of spiritual fruit and effectiveness.
3. **Why is the Word of God essential for walking with Christ (Psalm 119:105)?**
   - God's Word provides direction, wisdom, and strength for living a Christ-centered life.

4. **What role does the Holy Spirit play in walking with Christ (Galatians 5:16)?**
   - The Spirit empowers believers to resist sin and live according to God's will.
5. **How can walking with Christ transform your relationships with others?**
   - It fosters love, humility, and service, reflecting Christ's character in interactions.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Daily Devotion**: Set aside time each day to pray, read Scripture, and reflect on God's will for your life.
2. **Practice Obedience**: Identify one area where you can align your actions more closely with Christ's teachings.
3. **Serve with Love**: Look for ways to show Christ's love to someone in need this week.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the privilege of walking with Him through Christ.
2. Ask for the Holy Spirit's guidance and empowerment to live a Christ-centered life.
3. Pray for growth in love, faith, and obedience as you walk with Christ daily.

Sola Scriptura 2:49
Refuting Soul Sleep

FOCUS: EXAMINING THE BIBLICAL EVIDENCE AGAINST THE DOCTRINE OF SOUL SLEEP, WHICH TEACHES THAT THE SOUL BECOMES UNCONSCIOUS AFTER DEATH UNTIL THE RESURRECTION.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 2 Corinthians 5:8
- Philippians 1:23-24
- Luke 23:43

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Revelation 6:9-10
- Hebrews 9:27
- Matthew 17:3
- Ecclesiastes 12:7

WHAT IS SOUL SLEEP?

- Soul sleep is the belief that when a person dies, their soul becomes unconscious and remains in this state until the resurrection and final judgment. This view is held by groups like Seventh-day Adventists and some other movements.
- Advocates cite passages such as **Ecclesiastes 9:5** ("the dead know nothing") and **Psalm 146:4** to argue that death results in complete unconsciousness.

BIBLICAL EVIDENCE REFUTING SOUL SLEEP:

1. **The Soul is Immediately with Christ After Death**:

- **2 Corinthians 5:8**: Believers are confident that being absent from the body means being present with the Lord, indicating consciousness after death.
- **Philippians 1:23-24**: Paul expresses his desire to depart and be with Christ, which would not make sense if he expected unconsciousness.

2. **Jesus' Promise to the Thief on the Cross**:
   - **Luke 23:43**: Jesus promises the repentant thief, "Today you will be with Me in paradise," showing immediate conscious fellowship with Him after death.
3. **The Souls of the Martyrs in Revelation**:
   - **Revelation 6:9-10**: The souls of martyrs are depicted as conscious, crying out to God for justice, clearly contradicting the idea of unconsciousness.
4. **The Transfiguration of Moses and Elijah**:
   - **Matthew 17:3**: Moses and Elijah appear alive and speaking with Jesus, demonstrating that the righteous dead are conscious and active.
5. **The Spirit's Return to God**:
   - **Ecclesiastes 12:7**: The spirit returns to God upon death, distinguishing the body's physical death from the soul's continued existence.

COMMONLY MISINTERPRETED VERSES:

1. **Ecclesiastes 9:5**: "The dead know nothing."
   - Context: This describes life "under the sun," emphasizing that the dead have no active role in earthly affairs, not unconsciousness of the soul.
2. **Psalm 146:4**: "When their spirit departs, they return to the ground; on that very day their plans come to nothing."

- Context: This refers to the end of earthly ambitions, not the soul's activity after death.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 2 Corinthians 5:8 teach about the state of the soul after death?**
   - It affirms that believers are immediately in the presence of the Lord when absent from the body, indicating consciousness.
2. **How does Luke 23:43 refute soul sleep?**
   - Jesus' promise of being in paradise "today" demonstrates immediate conscious existence after death.
3. **What role do the martyrs' souls in Revelation 6:9-10 play in refuting soul sleep?**
   - Their active plea for justice shows that the souls of the righteous are aware and engaged.
4. **Why is Ecclesiastes 9:5 not evidence for soul sleep?**
   - The context addresses earthly existence, not the soul's condition in the afterlife.
5. **How does the Transfiguration of Moses and Elijah further disprove soul sleep?**
   - Their conscious presence with Jesus affirms that the righteous dead are alive and aware.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Strengthen Your Hope**: Trust in the promise of being with Christ immediately after death, bringing comfort in times of loss.
2. **Study Scripture Carefully**: Understand the context of verses often cited in favor of soul sleep to discern their true meaning.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share the biblical assurance of eternal life and conscious fellowship with God after death.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the promise of eternal life and conscious fellowship with Him after death.
2. Pray for clarity and understanding as you study His Word on this topic.
3. Ask for opportunities to comfort and encourage others with the hope of the gospel.

Sola Scriptura 2:50
Understanding Grace

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE BIBLICAL MEANING OF GRACE, ITS ROLE IN SALVATION, AND HOW IT TRANSFORMS THE LIVES OF BELIEVERS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:8-9
- Titus 2:11-12
- Romans 6:14

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- John 1:16-17
- Romans 5:20-21
- 2 Corinthians 12:9
- Hebrews 4:16

WHAT IS GRACE?

1. **Definition**: Grace is the unmerited favor of God, freely given, and not based on human effort or worthiness (Ephesians 2:8-9).
2. **Source of Salvation**: Grace is central to the gospel, as it is through grace that we are saved, justified, and reconciled to God (Titus 2:11).
3. **Empowerment for Holy Living**: Grace is not only about salvation but also about transforming believers to live godly lives (Titus 2:12, Romans 6:14).
4. **Sustaining Power**: God's grace strengthens and sustains believers through trials and weaknesses (2 Corinthians 12:9).

BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF GRACE:

- **The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32)**: A powerful illustration of the father's undeserved love and forgiveness.
- **Paul's Transformation (1 Timothy 1:13-14)**: Paul describes himself as the recipient of abundant grace despite his past persecution of the Church.
- **The Thief on the Cross (Luke 23:39-43)**: Jesus extends grace to a repentant criminal, offering him eternal life.

THE ROLE OF GRACE IN SALVATION:

1. **Justification**: Grace declares believers righteous before God through faith in Jesus Christ (Romans 3:24).
2. **Sanctification**: Grace empowers believers to grow in holiness and resist sin (Titus 2:12).
3. **Eternal Life**: Grace ensures the promise of eternal life with God, apart from works (Romans 6:23).

COMMON MISUNDERSTANDINGS OF GRACE:

1. **Grace as a License to Sin**: Some view grace as permission to live sinfully, but Scripture teaches that grace leads to godliness (Romans 6:1-2, Titus 2:12).
2. **Grace Plus Works**: Some believe grace must be earned or supplemented by works, but salvation is entirely a gift of God (Ephesians 2:8-9).
3. **Conditional Grace**: Grace is often misunderstood as conditional on human behavior, but true grace is freely given and cannot be earned (Romans 5:8).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Ephesians 2:8-9 teach about grace?**
   - Grace is a gift from God, entirely unearned, and is the means of salvation through faith.
2. **How does grace empower holy living (Titus 2:11-12)?**
   - Grace teaches us to reject sin and live upright, godly lives in this world.
3. **What does Paul mean when he says God's grace is sufficient (2 Corinthians 12:9)?**
   - God's grace provides strength and sustains believers even in their weaknesses and challenges.
4. **How does the story of the prodigal son illustrate grace?**
   - It shows the father's undeserved love and forgiveness, reflecting God's grace toward repentant sinners.
5. **Why is grace essential to the gospel?**
   - Without grace, salvation would depend on human effort, but the gospel is the good news that God saves us freely through Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on Grace**: Spend time thanking God for His unmerited favor in your life.
2. **Extend Grace to Others**: Show forgiveness and kindness to others, as God has shown grace to you.
3. **Rely on Grace Daily**: Trust God's sustaining grace in times of weakness and struggle.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of grace that brings salvation and transformation.
2. Pray for a deeper understanding of how to live in God's grace each day.
3. Ask God to help you extend His grace to others in your words and actions.

Sola Scriptura 2:51
The Difference Between Grace and Mercy

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE DISTINCT YET COMPLEMENTARY ROLES OF GRACE AND MERCY IN GOD'S REDEMPTIVE PLAN.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:4-5
- Hebrews 4:16
- Psalm 103:8

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Lamentations 3:22-23
- Titus 3:5
- Luke 18:13

WHAT IS GRACE?

- **Definition**: Grace is God's unmerited favor, giving us what we do not deserve, such as salvation, blessings, and eternal life (Ephesians 2:8-9).
- **Example**: A sinner is forgiven and adopted as a child of God through Christ.

WHAT IS MERCY?

- **Definition**: Mercy is God's compassion, withholding the punishment we deserve for our sins (Titus 3:5).

- **Example**: A guilty person is spared judgment due to God's love and kindness.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN GRACE AND MERCY:

1. **Focus**:
   - **Grace**: Giving us blessings we do not deserve.
   - **Mercy**: Protecting us from judgment we do deserve.
2. **Illustration**:
   - Mercy is a judge pardoning a criminal.
   - Grace is the judge adopting the criminal as their child.
3. **Role in Salvation**:
   - Mercy addresses our guilt and spares us from punishment.
   - Grace brings the gift of new life and relationship with God.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How do Ephesians 2:4-5 and Titus 3:5 differentiate between grace and mercy?**
   - Mercy spares us from death due to sin, while grace makes us alive with Christ and grants eternal blessings.
2. **Why are both grace and mercy essential to salvation?**
   - Without mercy, we would face eternal punishment. Without grace, we would not receive eternal life.
3. **How does Hebrews 4:16 encourage believers to approach God?**
   - It invites us to confidently seek both mercy for our sins and grace for strength in our needs.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on God's Mercy**: Take time to thank God for sparing you from judgment through Christ's sacrifice.

2. **Celebrate His Grace**: Rejoice in the unmerited blessings of salvation, adoption, and eternal life.
3. **Extend Both to Others**: Show mercy by forgiving, and grace by loving generously.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His mercy in forgiving your sins and His grace in blessing you beyond measure.
2. Pray for the ability to reflect God's mercy and grace in your relationships.
3. Ask for a deeper appreciation of these attributes in your daily walk with Christ.

Sola Scriptura 2:52

Living Under Grace, Not Law

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING HOW LIVING UNDER GRACE FREES BELIEVERS FROM THE CONDEMNATION OF THE LAW AND EMPOWERS THEM TO LIVE RIGHTEOUSLY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 6:14
- Galatians 2:21
- John 1:17

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:8-9
- Galatians 3:24-25
- Romans 8:1-2

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO LIVE UNDER GRACE?

1. **Freedom from Condemnation**: Believers are no longer judged by the law but are justified by faith in Christ (Romans 8:1-2).
2. **Empowered by the Spirit**: Grace enables believers to live holy lives through the power of the Holy Spirit, not by human effort (Galatians 5:16-18).
3. **Focus on Relationship, Not Rules**: Living under grace emphasizes a personal relationship with Christ over legalistic adherence to rules (John 15:5).

THE PURPOSE OF THE LAW:

1. **Reveals Sin**: The law shows humanity's inability to achieve righteousness on its own (Romans 3:20).
2. **Points to Christ**: The law serves as a tutor, leading us to the need for salvation through Christ (Galatians 3:24-25).
3. **Fulfilled by Jesus**: Christ perfectly fulfilled the law, offering grace to those who trust in Him (Matthew 5:17).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Romans 6:14 teach about grace and the law?**
   - Grace frees believers from the dominion of sin and the condemnation of the law.
2. **How does Galatians 3:24-25 explain the purpose of the law?**
   - The law acts as a guide to show our need for Christ, but once faith has come, we are no longer bound by it.
3. **What does it mean to live under grace, according to Romans 8:1-2?**
   - It means being free from condemnation and empowered by the Spirit to live righteously.
4. **Why is it important not to return to legalism (Galatians 2:21)?**
   - Depending on the law nullifies the grace of God and denies the sufficiency of Christ's sacrifice.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Walk in Freedom**: Embrace your identity in Christ, free from condemnation and empowered by grace.
2. **Avoid Legalism**: Resist the temptation to base your righteousness on rules instead of grace.
3. **Live in Gratitude**: Respond to God's grace with joyful obedience, motivated by love rather than obligation.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for setting you free from the condemnation of the law through His grace.
2. Pray for wisdom and strength to walk in the freedom and power of grace daily.
3. Ask for a heart of gratitude and love as you live in response to God's grace.

Sola Scriptura 2:53

The Law Fulfilled in Christ

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING HOW JESUS FULFILLED THE REQUIREMENTS OF THE LAW AND WHAT THIS MEANS FOR BELIEVERS UNDER THE NEW COVENANT.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Matthew 5:17
- Romans 8:3-4
- Hebrews 10:1

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 3:24-25
- Colossians 2:13-14
- Romans 10:4
- Hebrews 7:18-19

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON THE LAW FULFILLED IN CHRIST:

1. **Jesus as the Fulfillment**: Christ perfectly obeyed the law and fulfilled its requirements, offering His righteousness to all who believe (Matthew 5:17, Romans 8:3-4).
2. **Purpose of the Law**: The law reveals sin, points to the need for a Savior, and serves as a tutor leading to Christ (Galatians 3:24-25).
3. **The New Covenant**: Christ's sacrifice established a new covenant, replacing the ceremonial and sacrificial aspects of the law (Hebrews 10:1, Colossians 2:13-14).

4. **Freedom in Christ**: Believers are no longer under the law's condemnation but are empowered to live by the Spirit (Romans 10:4, Galatians 5:16).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Matthew 5:17 teach about Jesus' relationship to the law?**
   - Jesus fulfilled the law's moral, ceremonial, and sacrificial aspects, completing its purpose.
2. **How does Romans 8:3-4 explain why Christ had to fulfill the law?**
   - The law was powerless to save because of human sin, but Christ's sacrifice accomplished what the law could not.
3. **Why is the law described as a "shadow" in Hebrews 10:1?**
   - The law pointed forward to the reality of Christ's redemptive work, which fully accomplishes what the law symbolized.
4. **What does it mean that Christ is the culmination of the law (Romans 10:4)?**
   - It means Christ is the fulfillment and end goal of the law, providing righteousness for believers.
5. **How should believers live in light of Christ's fulfillment of the law?**
   - By walking in the Spirit, pursuing holiness, and living in gratitude for God's grace.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Celebrate Freedom**: Rejoice in the freedom from the law's condemnation through Christ's sacrifice.
2. **Pursue Holiness**: Follow Christ's example by living a life that reflects God's righteousness.

3. **Share the Gospel**: Explain how Christ fulfilled the law to someone who struggles with legalism or self-righteousness.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for sending Jesus to fulfill the law and provide salvation through grace.
2. Pray for the strength to live in the freedom of the Spirit while honoring God's commands.
3. Ask for opportunities to share this truth with others.

Sola Scriptura 2:54

Balancing Grace and Obedience

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN GOD'S GRACE AND THE BELIEVER'S CALL TO OBEDIENCE, AVOIDING EXTREMES OF LEGALISM AND LICENSE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:8-10
- Romans 6:1-2
- John 14:15

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Titus 2:11-12
- Philippians 2:12-13
- James 2:17
- 1 Peter 1:15-16

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON BALANCING GRACE AND OBEDIENCE:

1. **Grace as the Foundation**: Salvation is a free gift of grace, not earned by works, but it empowers believers to live obedient lives (Ephesians 2:8-10).
2. **Obedience as a Response**: True obedience flows from love for God and gratitude for His grace (John 14:15).
3. **Avoiding Extremes**:

- Legalism: Overemphasizing rules and human effort.
- License: Misusing grace as an excuse for sin (Romans 6:1-2).

4. **God's Role in Obedience**: The Holy Spirit works within believers to enable them to live in obedience to God's will (Philippians 2:12-13).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How do Ephesians 2:8-10 and James 2:17 complement each other?**
   - Salvation is by grace through faith, but genuine faith produces good works as evidence of transformation.
2. **What does Romans 6:1-2 teach about the misuse of grace?**
   - Grace is not a license to sin but a call to live in holiness.
3. **Why is obedience important in the Christian life (John 14:15)?**
   - Obedience is an expression of love and submission to Christ's authority.
4. **How does Philippians 2:12-13 describe the balance between human effort and God's work?**
   - Believers actively pursue obedience, knowing that God empowers them to do so.
5. **What practical steps can believers take to balance grace and obedience?**
   - Trust in God's grace, rely on the Spirit's power, and pursue holiness out of love for Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Examine Your Heart**: Identify areas where you might lean toward legalism or license and seek balance.
2. **Trust God's Power**: Rely on the Holy Spirit for strength to obey God's commands.
3. **Show Grace to Others**: Extend God's grace to those who struggle, encouraging them toward growth in Christ.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His grace, which saves and empowers you to live for Him.
2. Pray for wisdom and discernment to balance grace and obedience in your life.
3. Ask for opportunities to encourage others to live in grace-fueled obedience.

Sola Scriptura 2:55

The Assurance of Salvation

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING HOW BELIEVERS CAN HAVE CONFIDENCE IN THEIR SALVATION THROUGH THE PROMISES OF GOD, THE WORK OF CHRIST, AND THE WITNESS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 John 5:13
- Romans 8:16
- John 10:27-29

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 1:13-14
- Philippians 1:6
- 2 Timothy 1:12
- Romans 8:38-39

BIBLICAL BASIS FOR ASSURANCE OF SALVATION:

1. **God's Promises**: Assurance is based on the trustworthiness of God's Word, which guarantees eternal life to those who believe in Jesus (1 John 5:13, John 10:27-29).
2. **Christ's Finished Work**: Salvation is secure because it rests on Jesus' completed work on the cross, not on human effort (John 19:30, Ephesians 2:8-9).
3. **The Holy Spirit's Witness**: The Holy Spirit confirms in the hearts of believers that they are children of God (Romans 8:16, Ephesians 1:13-14).

4. **God's Faithfulness**: Salvation is sustained by God's power and faithfulness, not by human ability to remain faithful (Philippians 1:6, 2 Timothy 1:12).

COMMON STRUGGLES WITH ASSURANCE:

1. **Doubts About Worthiness**: Believers may question if they are "good enough," but salvation is based on grace, not performance (Ephesians 2:8-9).
2. **Fear of Falling Away**: Some worry about losing salvation, but Scripture affirms God's ability to keep His people (John 10:27-29, Romans 8:38-39).
3. **Struggles with Sin**: Ongoing struggles with sin can cause doubt, but the process of sanctification is evidence of God's work in a believer's life (Philippians 1:6).

PRACTICAL STEPS TO STRENGTHEN ASSURANCE:

1. **Know God's Word**: Regularly meditate on passages that affirm the security of salvation (1 John 5:13, Romans 8:38-39).
2. **Rely on the Holy Spirit**: Pray for the Spirit's assurance and guidance in your life (Romans 8:16).
3. **Look for Evidence of Transformation**: Assurance grows as believers see the fruit of the Spirit and their lives conforming to Christ's image (Galatians 5:22-23, 2 Corinthians 5:17).
4. **Confess and Repent**: Assurance is not about perfection but about continuing to trust in Christ and turn from sin (1 John 1:9).
5. **Trust in God's Faithfulness**: Focus on God's promises rather than your feelings or circumstances (Philippians 1:6, 2 Timothy 1:12).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does 1 John 5:13 provide assurance of salvation?**
   - It states that believers in Jesus can know they have eternal life, offering confidence based on faith in Him.
2. **What role does the Holy Spirit play in assurance (Romans 8:16)?**
   - The Spirit testifies to believers that they are children of God, providing an inner confirmation of salvation.
3. **Why is salvation secure according to John 10:27-29?**
   - Jesus assures that no one can snatch His sheep out of His hand, emphasizing the security of believers in His care.
4. **What does Philippians 1:6 teach about God's faithfulness in salvation?**
   - It promises that God will complete the work He began in believers, guaranteeing their ultimate redemption.
5. **How can struggles with sin affect assurance, and what is the solution?**
   - Struggles can cause doubt, but confessing sin and trusting God's grace restores confidence in His forgiveness (1 John 1:9).

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Memorize Key Verses**: Commit passages about assurance to memory for times of doubt or struggle.
2. **Cultivate a Relationship with God**: Spend time in prayer, worship, and Scripture to deepen your trust in Him.
3. **Encourage Others**: Share the promises of God's Word with fellow believers who may be struggling with assurance.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of eternal life and His promises that bring assurance.
2. Pray for the Holy Spirit to affirm your identity as a child of God.
3. Ask for boldness and confidence to live out your faith, resting in the assurance of salvation.

Sola Scriptura 2:56

The Fruit of Salvation

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE EVIDENCE OF GENUINE SALVATION AS SEEN IN THE TRANSFORMATION OF A BELIEVER'S LIFE AND THE FRUIT PRODUCED BY THE HOLY SPIRIT.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 5:22-23
- Matthew 7:16-17
- 2 Corinthians 5:17

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 2:10
- John 15:5
- James 2:17
- 1 John 3:18-19

EVIDENCE OF GENUINE SALVATION:

1. **Spiritual Transformation**: Salvation brings new life and a heart aligned with God's will (2 Corinthians 5:17).
2. **Fruit of the Spirit**: Genuine believers exhibit the characteristics of the Spirit's work in their lives (Galatians 5:22-23).
3. **Obedience to God's Word**: A life of obedience and holiness reflects a heart submitted to Christ (John 14:15).
4. **Good Works**: While not a basis for salvation, good works naturally flow from faith as evidence of transformation (Ephesians 2:10, James 2:17).

5. **Love for Others**: Love in action demonstrates a genuine relationship with God (1 John 3:18-19).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Galatians 5:22-23 teach about the evidence of salvation?**
   - The fruit of the Spirit reveals the inner transformation of believers, showing the character of Christ in their lives.
2. **How does Matthew 7:16-17 relate to identifying genuine believers?**
   - Jesus teaches that the fruit of a person's life—words, actions, and attitudes—indicates the nature of their heart.
3. **Why are good works important if salvation is by grace (Ephesians 2:10)?**
   - Good works are the result of salvation, showing that believers are created in Christ to fulfill God's purposes.
4. **How can believers cultivate the fruit of the Spirit (John 15:5)?**
   - By abiding in Christ through prayer, Scripture, and obedience, believers allow the Spirit to produce fruit in their lives.
5. **What role does love play in the evidence of salvation (1 John 3:18-19)?**
   - Love demonstrates the authenticity of faith, reflecting God's character and work in the believer's life.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Assess Your Life**: Reflect on areas where you see the fruit of the Spirit and areas where growth is needed.
2. **Abide in Christ**: Commit to daily prayer, Scripture study, and obedience to foster spiritual growth.

3. **Serve Others**: Look for ways to demonstrate love and good works as evidence of your faith.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the transformation He brings through salvation.
2. Pray for the Spirit's help in producing fruit in your life.
3. Ask for opportunities to love and serve others as a testimony of your faith.

Sola Scriptura 2:57

Knowing We Are Forgiven

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING THE ASSURANCE OF FORGIVENESS THROUGH CHRIST AND HOW TO LIVE IN THE FREEDOM OF GOD'S GRACE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 John 1:9
- Psalm 103:12
- Romans 8:1

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 1:7
- Isaiah 1:18
- Micah 7:18-19
- Hebrews 10:17

WHAT DOES FORGIVENESS MEAN?

1. **A Cleansing Act**: Forgiveness removes sin's stain, purifying us completely (Isaiah 1:18, 1 John 1:9).
2. **A Relational Restoration**: Forgiveness restores our relationship with God, broken by sin (Ephesians 1:7).
3. **A Complete Work**: God's forgiveness is total and final; He chooses to remember our sins no more (Psalm 103:12, Hebrews 10:17).

BIBLICAL BASIS FOR FORGIVENESS:

1. **Through Christ's Sacrifice**: Jesus' death on the cross paid the penalty for sin, securing forgiveness for all who believe (Ephesians 1:7, Romans 5:8-9).
2. **By Confession and Faith**: God promises forgiveness to those who confess their sins and trust in Christ's atonement (1 John 1:9).
3. **Rooted in God's Character**: God's mercy and steadfast love are the foundation of His forgiveness (Micah 7:18-19, Psalm 86:5).

LIVING IN THE ASSURANCE OF FORGIVENESS:

1. **Trust God's Promises**: Believe in the truth of Scripture, which assures forgiveness for those who are in Christ (Romans 8:1).
2. **Reject Condemnation**: Understand that guilt and shame do not come from God but from the enemy (Revelation 12:10).
3. **Forgive Yourself**: Accept God's forgiveness and let go of self-condemnation, recognizing that Christ's sacrifice is sufficient.
4. **Forgive Others**: Extend the forgiveness you have received, reflecting God's grace to others (Ephesians 4:32).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 John 1:9 teach about forgiveness?**
   - It assures that God forgives and purifies us when we confess our sins, based on His faithfulness and justice.
2. **How does Psalm 103:12 describe the completeness of God's forgiveness?**
   - It portrays forgiveness as total, removing our sins as far as the east is from the west.
3. **Why is there no condemnation for those in Christ (Romans 8:1)?**
   - Christ's death and resurrection satisfy God's justice, freeing believers from guilt and punishment.

4. **What does Hebrews 10:17 mean by God remembering our sins no more?**
   - It signifies that God chooses to no longer hold our sins against us, fully pardoning and forgetting them.
5. **How can believers confidently live as forgiven people?**
   - By trusting God's promises, rejecting lies of the enemy, and embracing the new life in Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Confess and Repent**: Bring any unconfessed sin to God, trusting in His promise to forgive and cleanse.
2. **Memorize Scripture**: Commit verses about forgiveness to memory for assurance in moments of doubt.
3. **Extend Forgiveness**: Practice forgiving others as God has forgiven you, demonstrating His grace.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the gift of forgiveness through Christ's sacrifice.
2. Pray for a deeper understanding of God's grace and the assurance of your forgiveness.
3. Ask for help in forgiving yourself and others, reflecting God's mercy in your life.

Sola Scriptura 2:58
Overcoming Guilt

FOCUS: UNDERSTANDING HOW TO OVERCOME GUILT THROUGH THE TRUTH OF GOD'S WORD, THE POWER OF FORGIVENESS, AND THE ASSURANCE OF CHRIST'S WORK ON THE CROSS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Romans 8:1
- Psalm 32:5
- Isaiah 43:25

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- 1 John 1:9
- Micah 7:18-19
- 2 Corinthians 5:17
- Hebrews 10:22

WHAT CAUSES GUILT?

1. **Unconfessed Sin**: Guilt often arises when sin remains unacknowledged before God (Psalm 32:5).
2. **False Guilt**: Feelings of guilt over forgiven sins or things that are not sinful, often stemming from condemnation by the enemy (Revelation 12:10).
3. **Unresolved Conflicts**: Guilt may persist when relationships are broken or forgiveness is withheld (Matthew 5:23-24).

OVERCOMING GUILT BIBLICALLY:

1. **Confess and Repent**: Bring sin to God in prayer, trusting His promise to forgive and cleanse (1 John 1:9).
2. **Believe in God's Promises**: Trust that God has fully forgiven your sin and removed your guilt (Isaiah 43:25, Micah 7:19).
3. **Live as a New Creation**: Embrace your new identity in Christ, free from the burden of past sins (2 Corinthians 5:17).
4. **Resist Condemnation**: Recognize that guilt over forgiven sin is a lie from the enemy and claim the truth of Romans 8:1.
5. **Seek Restoration**: If guilt stems from unresolved conflict, take steps to reconcile and seek peace (Matthew 5:23-24).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does Psalm 32:5 teach about overcoming guilt?**
   - It shows that acknowledging and confessing sin to God results in forgiveness and the removal of guilt.
2. **How does Romans 8:1 address feelings of condemnation?**
   - It assures believers that there is no condemnation for those in Christ, freeing them from guilt and shame.
3. **What role does confession play in overcoming guilt (1 John 1:9)?**
   - Confession brings cleansing and forgiveness, freeing believers from the weight of sin.
4. **How can believers resist false guilt?**
   - By relying on the truth of God's Word and rejecting lies from the enemy (Hebrews 10:22).

5. **Why is reconciliation important in overcoming guilt?**
   - Restoring broken relationships helps remove lingering guilt and reflects God's love and forgiveness.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Daily Confession**: Make confession a regular part of your prayer life to stay free from guilt.
2. **Memorize Key Verses**: Arm yourself with Scripture that reminds you of God's forgiveness and grace.
3. **Pursue Reconciliation**: Identify any unresolved conflicts and take steps to restore relationships.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His forgiveness and the freedom from guilt through Christ.
2. Pray for discernment to recognize false guilt and the lies of condemnation.
3. Ask for courage to reconcile with others and live in peace.

Sola Scriptura 2:59

The Freedom Found in Forgiveness

FOCUS: DISCOVERING HOW FORGIVENESS, BOTH RECEIVED AND EXTENDED, BRINGS FREEDOM FROM BITTERNESS, GUILT, AND RELATIONAL STRIFE.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Colossians 3:13
- Matthew 6:14-15
- John 8:36

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 4:31-32
- Matthew 18:21-22
- Psalm 86:5
- Romans 12:18

WHAT FREEDOM DOES FORGIVENESS BRING?

1. **Freedom from Bitterness**: Forgiveness releases resentment and prevents a root of bitterness from growing (Ephesians 4:31-32).
2. **Freedom from Guilt**: Forgiveness reminds believers of God's grace, enabling them to let go of self-condemnation (John 8:36).
3. **Freedom in Relationships**: Forgiveness fosters reconciliation and peace, breaking down walls of division (Romans 12:18).
4. **Freedom to Reflect Christ**: Forgiving others demonstrates God's love and grace, pointing them to the gospel (Colossians 3:13).

PRACTICAL STEPS TO EMBRACE FREEDOM IN FORGIVENESS:

1. **Receive God's Forgiveness**: Accept God's grace and forgiveness for your sins as the foundation for forgiving others (Psalm 86:5).
2. **Choose to Forgive**: Forgiveness is a decision, not a feeling. Release others from the debt they owe you (Matthew 18:21-22).
3. **Pray for Those Who Hurt You**: Pray for healing and blessing for those who have wronged you, aligning your heart with God's (Matthew 5:44).
4. **Let Go of Retaliation**: Trust God to bring justice and focus on pursuing peace (Romans 12:19-21).
5. **Seek Reconciliation**: When possible, take steps to restore broken relationships, reflecting God's heart for unity (Romans 12:18).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why is forgiving others essential (Matthew 6:14-15)?**
   - Forgiving others reflects God's forgiveness in our lives and restores fellowship with Him.
2. **How does forgiveness free us from bitterness (Ephesians 4:31-32)?**
   - It removes resentment and replaces it with kindness and compassion, breaking the cycle of hurt.
3. **What does it mean to forgive as the Lord forgave you (Colossians 3:13)?**
   - It means forgiving completely, without holding grudges, just as Christ forgives our sins.
4. **Why is praying for those who hurt us important (Matthew 5:44)?**

- It transforms our hearts, aligning us with God's love and helping us release anger.

5. **How does forgiving others bring peace to relationships (Romans 12:18)?**
   - Forgiveness fosters reconciliation and unity, creating opportunities for healing and restored fellowship.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Reflect on God's Forgiveness**: Spend time thanking God for forgiving your sins and letting His grace inspire you to forgive others.
2. **Identify Resentments**: Ask God to reveal any bitterness or unforgiveness in your heart and help you release it.
3. **Actively Forgive**: Reach out to someone you need to forgive or reconcile with, trusting God to work in the situation.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the freedom found in His forgiveness and grace.
2. Pray for strength and humility to forgive those who have hurt you.
3. Ask for healing and reconciliation in relationships affected by unforgiveness.

Sola Scriptura 2:60
Refuting the Claim that the Bible is Sexist

FOCUS: EXAMINING THE BIBLICAL TEACHING ON GENDER AND ADDRESSING MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT SEXISM IN SCRIPTURE BY HIGHLIGHTING GOD'S DESIGN FOR EQUALITY, DIGNITY, AND COMPLEMENTARY ROLES.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Genesis 1:27
- Galatians 3:28
- Proverbs 31:10-31

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Ephesians 5:25-28
- 1 Peter 3:7
- Exodus 1:15-21
- Luke 8:1-3

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON GENDER:

1. **Equality in Creation**:
   - Both men and women are made in the image of God, with equal value, dignity, and worth (Genesis 1:27).
   - God gave men and women shared dominion over creation, reflecting their equal standing before Him (Genesis 1:28).

2. **Complementary Roles, Not Inferiority**:
   - The Bible outlines distinct roles for men and women in the home and church, but these roles are complementary, not hierarchical in value (Ephesians 5:22-33).
   - Headship and submission, as taught in Scripture, are rooted in mutual love and respect, modeled after Christ and the Church (Ephesians 5:25-28).
3. **Examples of Women's Leadership**:
   - Deborah: A judge and leader of Israel, demonstrating God's empowerment of women in leadership (Judges 4:4-5).
   - Esther: A queen who saved her people through courage and faith (Esther 4:14-16).
   - Lydia: A businesswoman and early supporter of Paul's ministry (Acts 16:14-15).
   - Women were the first witnesses to the resurrection of Jesus, a role of immense importance in proclaiming the gospel (Matthew 28:1-10).

ADDRESSING COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS:

1. **Claim**: The Bible condones the oppression of women.
   - **Response**: The Bible consistently affirms the dignity and value of women. Passages that appear oppressive are often cultural descriptions, not prescriptive commands. For example, the treatment of women in ancient times is addressed in ways that often protect and elevate them (Exodus 22:22-24).
2. **Claim**: Paul's teachings on women's roles are sexist.
   - **Response**: Paul emphasizes equality in Christ (Galatians 3:28) while recognizing complementary roles in the home and church. His instructions reflect God's order, not inferiority (Ephesians 5:22-25).

3. **Claim**: Old Testament laws demean women.
   - **Response**: Many Old Testament laws were designed to protect women in a patriarchal society, ensuring justice and care for vulnerable individuals (Deuteronomy 24:1-4).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does Genesis 1:27 refute the idea that the Bible is sexist?**
   - It affirms that both men and women are created equally in the image of God, sharing equal value and dignity.
2. **What does Galatians 3:28 teach about equality in Christ?**
   - It emphasizes that in Christ, there is no distinction in worth or status between genders, races, or social positions.
3. **How does Proverbs 31 portray women?**
   - As strong, wise, industrious, and valuable, showing that the Bible honors and celebrates women's contributions.
4. **Why are Paul's teachings on gender roles not sexist?**
   - Paul's instructions promote mutual love, respect, and unity, reflecting God's design for complementary roles, not inequality.
5. **What examples of women in leadership show the Bible's support for their roles?**
   - Deborah, Esther, Lydia, and the women at the resurrection demonstrate that God uses women in significant ways to fulfill His purposes.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Celebrate Equality**: Acknowledge the equal value of men and women as image-bearers of God in your interactions and relationships.
2. **Study Women in Scripture**: Explore the stories of women in the Bible to understand their vital roles in God's plan.

3. **Live Out Biblical Roles**: Embrace God's design for men and women with humility, love, and mutual respect.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for creating men and women in His image, with equal value and worth.
2. Pray for wisdom and humility to live out His design for gender roles in a way that honors Him.
3. Ask for discernment in addressing misconceptions about Scripture with grace and truth.

Sola Scriptura 2:61
Understanding Gender Roles in the Church

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE BIBLICAL TEACHING ON GENDER ROLES WITHIN THE CHURCH AND HOW THEY REFLECT GOD'S DESIGN FOR UNITY, ORDER, AND EFFECTIVE MINISTRY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Timothy 2:11-12
- 1 Corinthians 14:34-35
- Ephesians 4:11-12

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 3:28
- Titus 2:3-5
- Romans 16:1-2
- Acts 18:24-26

BIBLICAL PRINCIPLES FOR GENDER ROLES IN THE CHURCH:

1. **Equality in Christ**: Men and women share equal worth and value as members of the body of Christ (Galatians 3:28).
2. **Distinct Roles**: Scripture outlines distinct roles for men and women in the Church, designed for order and effectiveness (1 Timothy 2:11-12).
3. **Teaching and Authority**: While some leadership roles, such as elder or pastor, are reserved for men, women are called to teach,

disciple, and serve in many capacities (Titus 2:3-5, Romans 16:1-2).

4. **Partnership in Ministry**: Men and women often work together in ministry, as seen with Priscilla and Aquila (Acts 18:24-26).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What does 1 Timothy 2:11-12 teach about women's roles in the Church?**
   - It addresses the roles of teaching and authority, reserving certain leadership positions for men while affirming the value of women's contributions.
2. **How does Galatians 3:28 relate to gender roles?**
   - It highlights the spiritual equality of men and women in Christ while acknowledging distinct roles within the Church.
3. **What examples in Scripture show women serving in ministry?**
   - Phoebe as a deacon (Romans 16:1-2), Priscilla teaching Apollos (Acts 18:24-26), and women supporting Jesus' ministry (Luke 8:1-3).
4. **How can men and women partner effectively in ministry?**
   - By respecting and embracing their God-given roles, working together to advance the gospel.
5. **Why are gender roles in the Church important?**
   - They reflect God's design for order, unity, and the effective functioning of the body of Christ.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Honor Biblical Roles**: Embrace and support the roles God has outlined for men and women in the Church.
2. **Encourage Others**: Recognize and affirm the gifts and contributions of both men and women in ministry.

3. **Serve Faithfully**: Use your gifts to build up the Church, regardless of your role or position.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His design for unity and diversity within the Church.
2. Pray for humility and wisdom to embrace and fulfill your role in ministry.
3. Ask for discernment in addressing questions about gender roles with grace and truth.

Sola Scriptura 2:62
Biblical Examples of Women in Ministry

FOCUS: HIGHLIGHTING THE ROLES OF WOMEN IN MINISTRY THROUGHOUT SCRIPTURE AND HOW THEIR CONTRIBUTIONS REFLECT GOD'S PURPOSES AND PLANS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Judges 4:4-5
- Romans 16:1-2
- Acts 18:26

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Luke 8:1-3
- Exodus 1:15-21
- Esther 4:14
- 2 Timothy 1:5

EXAMPLES OF WOMEN IN MINISTRY:

1. **Deborah (Judges 4-5)**: A prophet and judge, Deborah provided spiritual and political leadership for Israel.
2. **Phoebe (Romans 16:1-2)**: A deacon and trusted servant of the Church, commended by Paul for her ministry.
3. **Priscilla (Acts 18:26)**: Partnered with her husband to teach and disciple others, including the gifted preacher Apollos.
4. **Mary Magdalene and Other Women (Luke 8:1-3)**: Supported Jesus' ministry through financial and practical means.

5. **Lois and Eunice (2 Timothy 1:5)**: Passed on their faith to Timothy, shaping a key leader in the early Church.

LESSONS FROM WOMEN IN MINISTRY:

1. **Courage and Leadership**: Deborah and Esther show that God calls women to leadership roles when needed for His purposes.
2. **Teaching and Discipling**: Priscilla demonstrates the importance of women in teaching and mentoring others in the faith.
3. **Support and Service**: Women like Phoebe and Mary Magdalene highlight the vital role of serving and supporting the Church.
4. **Faith Legacy**: Lois and Eunice illustrate the generational impact of women's faith and teaching.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How did Deborah's leadership reflect God's call for women in ministry (Judges 4:4-5)?**
   - She served as a prophet and judge, providing wisdom and guidance to Israel in a time of need.
2. **What role did Phoebe play in the early Church (Romans 16:1-2)?**
   - She served as a deacon, a trusted leader, and a helper to many, including Paul.
3. **How did Priscilla contribute to discipleship in the early Church (Acts 18:26)?**
   - She, alongside her husband Aquila, taught Apollos, helping him understand the gospel more fully.
4. **Why are the women who supported Jesus' ministry significant (Luke 8:1-3)?**
   - They demonstrate the vital role of women in sustaining and advancing ministry efforts.

5. **What can we learn from Lois and Eunice about the impact of women's faith (2 Timothy 1:5)?**
    - Their faith influenced Timothy, a key leader in the early Church, showing the importance of nurturing faith in others.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Celebrate Women's Contributions**: Recognize and value the vital roles women play in ministry today.
2. **Follow Their Example**: Emulate the faith, courage, and service of women in Scripture in your own life and ministry.
3. **Encourage Women in Ministry**: Support and uplift women who are serving faithfully in various capacities within the Church.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the examples of women in Scripture who faithfully served Him.
2. Pray for strength and encouragement for women serving in ministry today.
3. Ask God to reveal how you can support and participate in ministry as He leads.

Sola Scriptura 2:63

Encouraging Women in Leadership

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATIONS FOR ENCOURAGING WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP ROLES WITHIN THE CHURCH AND COMMUNITY, RECOGNIZING THEIR GOD-GIVEN GIFTS AND CONTRIBUTIONS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Judges 4:4-5
- Romans 16:1-2
- Acts 18:26

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Proverbs 31:10-31
- Micah 6:4
- Luke 8:1-3
- 2 Timothy 1:5

BIBLICAL EXAMPLES OF WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP:

1. **Deborah (Judges 4:4-5)**: A prophet and judge, Deborah led Israel with wisdom and courage during a critical time.
2. **Phoebe (Romans 16:1-2)**: A deacon and trusted leader in the early Church, commended by Paul for her ministry.
3. **Priscilla (Acts 18:26)**: A teacher and mentor who, alongside her husband Aquila, played a key role in discipling others.
4. **Miriam (Micah 6:4)**: Recognized as a leader alongside Moses and Aaron in guiding Israel.

5. **Women Supporting Jesus' Ministry (Luke 8:1-3)**: Financially and practically sustained Jesus' work, demonstrating leadership in service.

ENCOURAGING WOMEN IN LEADERSHIP:

1. **Recognize Gifts**: Affirm the spiritual gifts God has given women, encouraging their use in leadership and ministry (1 Corinthians 12:4-6).
2. **Create Opportunities**: Provide avenues for women to lead and serve in meaningful ways within the Church and community.
3. **Offer Mentorship**: Encourage seasoned leaders, both men and women, to mentor women in their spiritual growth and leadership roles.
4. **Promote Unity**: Encourage collaboration between men and women in leadership, reflecting the unity of the body of Christ (Galatians 3:28).
5. **Celebrate Success**: Share and celebrate the contributions of women leaders, both past and present.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **What can we learn from Deborah's leadership in Judges 4:4-5?**
   - God called and empowered her to lead Israel during a time of crisis, showing His affirmation of women in leadership.
2. **Why is Phoebe's role significant in Romans 16:1-2?**
   - Paul commends her as a deacon and helper, recognizing her leadership and service in the Church.
3. **How does Priscilla's ministry in Acts 18:26 model leadership?**
   - She teaches and mentors others, demonstrating that women can play critical roles in spiritual guidance.

4. **What lessons can we learn from the women who supported Jesus' ministry (Luke 8:1-3)?**
   - Their leadership in service and generosity highlights the importance of diverse contributions to ministry.
5. **How can the Church better support women in leadership today?**
   - By affirming their gifts, providing opportunities for service, and fostering an environment of mutual respect and encouragement.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Encourage a Woman in Leadership**: Reach out to affirm and support a woman serving in a leadership role.
2. **Mentor or Be Mentored**: Seek opportunities to mentor women in their faith and ministry or be mentored by a godly woman leader.
3. **Create Space for Growth**: Advocate for programs or ministries that encourage and equip women for leadership roles.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the examples of women leaders in Scripture and their faithfulness.
2. Pray for wisdom and courage for women serving in leadership today.
3. Ask God to reveal ways you can support and encourage women in their roles.

Sola Scriptura 2:64
Addressing Modern Misconceptions About Women in the Church

FOCUS: CHALLENGING COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT WOMEN'S ROLES IN THE CHURCH BY EXPLORING BIBLICAL TEACHING AND PRACTICAL APPLICATIONS.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- Galatians 3:28
- 1 Corinthians 12:12-14
- 1 Peter 3:7

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Proverbs 31:10-31
- Acts 16:14-15
- Romans 16:3-4
- Exodus 1:15-21

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS ABOUT WOMEN IN THE CHURCH:

1. **"The Bible Restricts Women from Serving in Ministry"**:
   - **Biblical Response**: Women served in significant roles, such as Deborah (Judges 4:4-5), Phoebe (Romans 16:1-2), and Priscilla (Acts 18:26). While certain leadership roles may be distinct, the Bible celebrates women's contributions.

2. **"Women Should Be Silent in Church"**:
   - **Biblical Response**: Passages like 1 Corinthians 14:34-35 must be understood in their cultural and contextual framework. Women were encouraged to pray, prophesy, and teach in appropriate settings (Acts 2:17-18, Titus 2:3-5).
3. **"Women's Roles Are Less Important Than Men's"**:
   - **Biblical Response**: Men and women have different but equally valuable roles in the body of Christ (1 Corinthians 12:12-14, Galatians 3:28).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **How does Galatians 3:28 refute the idea that women are less valued in the Church?**
   - It affirms the spiritual equality of men and women in Christ.
2. **What roles did women serve in the early Church (Romans 16:1-4)?**
   - Women like Phoebe and Priscilla served as deacons, teachers, and ministry partners, showing their active participation in leadership.
3. **Why must cultural context be considered in interpreting passages about women (1 Corinthians 14:34-35)?**
   - These passages addressed specific cultural situations and do not negate the broader teaching of women's roles in ministry.
4. **How can the Church challenge modern misconceptions about women?**
   - By teaching biblical truths about equality and roles, celebrating women's contributions, and providing opportunities for service.
5. **What examples of women in Scripture inspire confidence in their role today?**
   - Deborah, Esther, Lydia, and Priscilla demonstrate courage, leadership, and faithfulness in fulfilling God's purposes.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Study Scripture in Context**: Gain a deeper understanding of passages about women's roles by exploring their cultural and historical context.
2. **Challenge Misconceptions**: Speak up against false beliefs about women's roles in the Church and share biblical truth.
3. **Celebrate Women's Contributions**: Highlight and honor the impact of women in your church and community.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for the truth of Scripture that affirms the value and roles of women in His plan.
2. Pray for wisdom in addressing misconceptions about women in the Church with grace and truth.
3. Ask God to empower and guide women in fulfilling their God-given roles in ministry and leadership.

Sola Scriptura 2:65

Explaining Why Elders Are Men

FOCUS: EXPLORING THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION FOR THE TEACHING THAT THE ROLE OF ELDER IN THE CHURCH IS RESERVED FOR MEN, WHILE AFFIRMING THE VALUE AND CONTRIBUTIONS OF BOTH MEN AND WOMEN IN MINISTRY.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- 1 Timothy 3:1-7
- Titus 1:5-9
- 1 Corinthians 11:3

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- Genesis 2:18
- Ephesians 5:22-25
- 1 Peter 5:2-3

BIBLICAL TEACHING ON ELDERSHIP:

1. **God's Design for Leadership**:
   - Throughout Scripture, God establishes men as the primary leaders in the family (Genesis 2:18) and in the Church (1 Timothy 3:1-7). This is not based on superiority but on God's design for order and complementarity.
2. **Qualifications for Elders**:
   - Paul's instructions for elders in 1 Timothy 3:1-7 and Titus 1:5-9 specify male pronouns ("he," "husband of one wife") and emphasize male headship in leadership roles.

3. **Headship and Responsibility**:
   - Biblical headship reflects God's order, where men are called to lead with humility, love, and sacrifice, as modeled by Christ (Ephesians 5:22-25, 1 Corinthians 11:3). Elders are to shepherd the Church in the same Christlike manner (1 Peter 5:2-3).
4. **Role Distinction, Not Value Distinction**:
   - The limitation of eldership to men does not diminish the value of women. Both men and women are equally created in God's image (Genesis 1:27) and have vital roles in the Church.

ADDRESSING COMMON MISUNDERSTANDINGS:

1. **"Reserving eldership for men means women are less important."**
   - **Response**: Eldership is about role distinction, not value. Women are honored and affirmed throughout Scripture for their contributions to ministry (Romans 16:1-3, Acts 18:26).
2. **"Paul's teachings were cultural and no longer apply."**
   - **Response**: Paul grounds his teaching in creation, not culture, showing that these roles reflect God's design (1 Timothy 2:12-13, Genesis 2:18).
3. **"The Bible contradicts itself by including women in leadership."**
   - **Response**: Women in Scripture serve in many significant roles (prophets, deacons, leaders), but the office of elder or overseer is distinct and reserved for men (1 Timothy 3:1-7, Titus 1:5-9).

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS:

1. **Why does 1 Timothy 3:1-7 specify men for the role of elder?**
   - The qualifications explicitly refer to men, grounding leadership in God's design for male headship in the Church and home.
2. **What does 1 Corinthians 11:3 teach about headship?**

- It establishes an order of headship where men are called to lead with Christlike humility and love.

3. **How does Genesis 2:18 support the idea of complementary roles?**
   - It highlights God's design for men and women to work together in distinct yet complementary roles.
4. **How do Ephesians 5:22-25 and 1 Peter 5:2-3 shape the elder's role?**
   - Elders are to model Christlike leadership, serving with humility, love, and care for the flock.
5. **What role do women play in Church leadership?**
   - Women serve in many critical roles, including teaching, discipleship, service, and ministry leadership, but the specific office of elder is reserved for men.

APPLICATIONS:

1. **Honor God's Design**: Embrace and affirm the roles God has established for men and women in the Church.
2. **Support Elders**: Pray for and encourage the men serving as elders to lead with humility, wisdom, and Christlike love.
3. **Celebrate Contributions**: Recognize and affirm the vital contributions of both men and women in building up the body of Christ.

PRAYER PROMPTS:

1. Thank God for His design for leadership in the Church and His wisdom in establishing complementary roles.
2. Pray for the elders in your Church to lead faithfully and reflect Christ's love.
3. Ask God for wisdom and grace in understanding and affirming His plan for leadership.

Glossary

As with any field of study, there are terms that are specific to that area, and a study of God's Word is no different. I have tried to define what those terms mean when used in a study so that anyone using these guides will have a "common" understanding of how I use them.

Core Doctrinal Terms

- **Justification**

  God's legal declaration that a sinner is righteous by faith in Christ, based on Christ's righteousness, not their own (Romans 5:1).

- **Sanctification**

  The lifelong process by which God makes believers holy, conforming them to the image of Christ (1 Thessalonians 4:3).

- **Glorification**

  The final state of salvation when believers are made perfect and receive resurrection bodies (Romans 8:30).

- **Redemption**

  The act of Christ purchasing sinners from the bondage of sin and death through His blood (Ephesians 1:7).

- **Salvation**

  Deliverance from sin and its consequences, granted by God through faith in Jesus Christ (Ephesians 2:8–9).

- **Election**

  God's sovereign choice, before the foundation of the world, to save certain individuals by grace (Ephesians 1:4–5).

- **Predestination**

  God's predetermined plan to bring His elect to salvation and conform them to Christ (Romans 8:29–30).

- **Atonement**

  Christ's sacrificial death on the cross that satisfies God's justice and makes reconciliation with God possible (Isaiah 53:5).

- **Propitiation**

  The appeasement of God's wrath by the sacrifice of Christ, making God favorable toward the believer (1 John 2:2).

- **Righteousness**

  The moral perfection required by God, fulfilled in Christ and credited to believers by faith (2 Corinthians 5:21).

- **Grace**

  God's unearned favor and kindness toward sinners, giving them salvation and blessings they do not deserve (Titus 2:11).

- **Mercy**

  God's compassionate withholding of the judgment and punishment deserved for sin (Ephesians 2:4–5).

- **Faith**

  Trust and confidence in God, especially in His promises and in the person and work of Jesus Christ (Hebrews 11:1).

- **Works**

  Actions done in obedience to God's commands; they do not save but are evidence of true faith (James 2:17).

- **Imputation**

The act of God crediting Christ's righteousness to believers and their sin to Christ (Romans 4:22–24).

- **Original Sin**

  The inherited sin nature and guilt from Adam's fall that affects all humanity (Romans 5:12).

- **Sin Nature**

  The inner inclination of humans to rebel against God, inherited from Adam (Galatians 5:17).

- **Repentance**

  A sincere turning from sin to God, involving sorrow for sin and a changed heart and life (Acts 3:19).

- **Confession**

  Acknowledging one's sin before God in truth, often accompanied by repentance and faith (1 John 1:9).

- **Regeneration**

  The spiritual rebirth by which the Holy Spirit gives new life to the believer (Titus 3:5).

- **New Birth**

  Another term for regeneration; being "born again" by the Spirit through faith in Christ (John 3:3).

- **Covenant (Old Covenant / New Covenant)**

  A binding agreement made by God with His people:

  Old Covenant: The Mosaic Law given to Israel (Exodus 19–24).

  New Covenant: The promise of salvation and transformed hearts through Christ's blood (Jeremiah 31:31–34; Luke 22:20).

Christological Terms

- **Messiah**

  The Anointed One promised in the Old Testament, fulfilled in Jesus Christ, who came to save and reign as King (Daniel 9:25–26; John 4:25–26).

- **Son of God**

  A title expressing Jesus' divine nature, uniquely begotten of the Father, equal with God (John 5:18; Hebrews 1:3).

- **Son of Man**

  A title Jesus used for Himself, highlighting both His humanity and His identity as the exalted figure in Daniel's vision (Daniel 7:13–14; Mark 10:45).

- **Christ**

  The Greek equivalent of "Messiah," meaning "Anointed One," referring to Jesus as the divinely appointed Savior and King (Matthew 16:16).

- **Lamb of God**

  A title for Jesus pointing to His role as the perfect sacrificial offering who takes away the sin of the world (John 1:29).

- **Lion of Judah**

  A title for Jesus symbolizing His authority, kingship, and power, rooted in the tribe of Judah (Revelation 5:5).

- **Incarnation**

  The act of God the Son taking on human flesh in the person of Jesus Christ (John 1:14; Philippians 2:6–7).

- **Resurrection**

  The bodily rising of Jesus from the dead on the third day, proving His victory over sin and death (1 Corinthians 15:3–4).

- **Ascension**

  Jesus' return to heaven in His glorified body, where He now reigns at the right hand of the Father (Acts 1:9–11; Ephesians 1:20).

- **Mediator**

  Jesus is the one who reconciles God and humanity by His death and intercession (1 Timothy 2:5).

- **Intercessor**

  Jesus continually pleads on behalf of believers before the Father, securing their standing and help (Romans 8:34; Hebrews 7:25).

- **High Priest**

  Jesus, who offers Himself as the perfect sacrifice and continually represents believers before God (Hebrews 4:14–16).

- **Lordship of Christ**

  The truth that Jesus is sovereign over all creation and should be obeyed and worshiped as Lord (Philippians 2:9–11; Romans 10:9).

- **Deity of Christ**

  The doctrine that Jesus is fully God, possessing all the attributes of divinity (Colossians 2:9; John 1:1).

- **Jesus Christ**

  The full name of the Savior: *Jesus* (His human name, meaning "Yahweh saves") and *Christ* (His title as the Anointed One) - fully God, fully man, Redeemer and Lord (Matthew 1:21; John 20:31).

Pneumatology (Holy Spirit)

- **Holy Spirit**

  The third Person of the Trinity, fully God, who regenerates, indwells, empowers, teaches, and guides believers (John 14:26; Acts 5:3–4).

- **Indwelling**

  The permanent presence of the Holy Spirit within every true believer, beginning at salvation (Romans 8:9; 1 Corinthians 3:16).

- **Sealing**

  The Holy Spirit's mark of ownership and guarantee of the believer's eternal inheritance in Christ (Ephesians 1:13–14).

- **Spiritual Gifts**

  Special abilities given by the Holy Spirit to believers for the building up of the Church and service to others (1 Corinthians 12:4–7; Romans 12:6–8).

- **Fruit of the Spirit**

  The character traits produced in a believer's life as they walk in the Spirit (Galatians 5:22–23).

- **Conviction**

  The Holy Spirit's work of making a person aware of sin, righteousness, and judgment, leading to repentance (John 16:8).

- **Empowerment**

  The Holy Spirit's enabling of believers to live godly lives and serve effectively in ministry and witness (Acts 1:8; Galatians 5:16).

- **Anointing**

  The setting apart and empowering by the Holy Spirit for a specific purpose or ministry, often associated with teaching, leadership, or service (1 John 2:20, 27; Luke 4:18).

Anthropology (Humanity)

- **Image of God (Imago Dei)**

  The unique way human beings reflect God's nature, including rationality, morality, creativity, relationship, and dominion - giving every person inherent value (Genesis 1:26–27).

- **Total Depravity**

  The condition of humanity after the Fall, meaning every part of the human being is affected by sin, rendering people unable to seek God without divine grace (Romans 3:10–12; Ephesians 2:1).

- **Free Will**

  The capacity to choose; though human will is real, it is limited and influenced by sin until freed by God's grace (Joshua 24:15; Romans 6:17–18).

- **Body/Soul/Spirit**

  The tripartite nature of humanity:

  Body – physical aspect,

  Soul – the seat of emotions and mind,

  Spirit – the part capable of communion with God (1 Thessalonians 5:23; Hebrews 4:12).

- **Gender**

  God's intentional creation of humanity as male and female, equal in value but distinct in role and design (Genesis 1:27; Matthew 19:4–5).

- **Identity**

  A person's true self as defined by God, not by the world - for believers, it is rooted in being a new creation in Christ (2 Corinthians 5:17; Galatians 2:20).

- **Conscience**

  The inner moral compass given by God that distinguishes right from wrong, though it can be weakened or seared by sin (Romans 2:14–15; 1 Timothy 4:2).

- **Flesh vs. Spirit**

  The ongoing conflict between the sinful human nature ("flesh") and the Holy Spirit within the believer (Galatians 5:16–17; Romans 8:5–8).

- **Human Dignity**

  The inherent worth of every human life as made in God's image, regardless of age, ability, or status (Psalm 8:4–5; James 3:9).

- **Temptation**

  An enticement to sin that appeals to desire; not sin itself, but a test of obedience (James 1:13–15; Matthew 4:1–11).

- **Desire**

  God-given longings that can be holy or sinful depending on their object and direction (Psalm 37:4; James 4:1–3).

- **Self-Denial**

  The deliberate choice to forsake selfish desires and submit to God's will, essential to true discipleship (Luke 9:23; Titus 2:11–12).

Ecclesiology (Church Life)

- **Saints**

  All true believers in Christ who are set apart (sanctified) by God and called to live holy lives (Romans 1:7; 1 Corinthians 1:2).

- **Church**

  The collective body of believers in Jesus Christ, both universal (all Christians) and local (individual congregations), called out to worship, serve, and proclaim the gospel (Matthew 16:18; Acts 2:42).

- **Body of Christ**

  A metaphor describing the Church as a living organism, with Christ as the head and believers as individual members, each with unique roles (1 Corinthians 12:12–27; Ephesians 1:22–23).

- **Unity**

  The spiritual oneness of believers, founded on shared faith in Christ and maintained through love, humility, and truth (Ephesians 4:3–6; John 17:21).

- **Elders**

  Spiritually mature men appointed to lead, teach, shepherd, and oversee the church (also called pastors or overseers) (1 Timothy 3:1–7; Titus 1:5–9).

- **Discipline**

  The loving correction of sin within the Church to restore the believer and protect the holiness of the body (Matthew 18:15–17; Hebrews 12:11).

- **Fellowship**

  The deep spiritual bond among believers marked by shared life, worship, encouragement, and mutual support (Acts 2:42; 1 John 1:7).

- **Membership**

  Formal identification and commitment to a local body of believers for accountability, service, and mutual edification (Romans 12:4–5; Hebrews 13:17).

- **Priesthood of Believers**

  The truth that all Christians have direct access to God through Christ and are called to minister, pray, and serve as His representatives (1 Peter 2:5, 9; Revelation 1:6).

- **Corporate Worship**

  The gathered expression of adoration, praise, prayer, and Word-centered teaching among believers, glorifying God together (Psalm 95:6; Colossians 3:16).

- **Spiritual Authority**

  God-given leadership and oversight within the Church, exercised by pastors/elders in accordance with Scripture and under Christ's lordship (Hebrews 13:17; 1 Peter 5:2–3).

- **Church Leadership**

  Biblical leadership within the church, primarily including elders and deacons, charged with shepherding, teaching, decision-

making, and modeling godly character (1 Timothy 3:1–13; Acts 20:28).

Missiology & Evangelism

- **Great Commission**

  Jesus' command to His followers to go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them and teaching them to obey all He has commanded (Matthew 28:18–20).

- **Gospel**

  The "good news" of Jesus Christ's life, death, and resurrection to save sinners, offering forgiveness and eternal life by grace through faith (1 Corinthians 15:1–4; Romans 1:16).

- **Witness**

  A believer who testifies to the truth of Christ by words and actions, declaring what God has done in their life (Acts 1:8).

- **Evangelism**

  The act of proclaiming the gospel to others with the goal of leading them to faith in Christ (Romans 10:14–15; 2 Timothy 4:5).

- **Mission**

  The Church's God-given task to reach the world with the gospel, making Christ known among all people (John 20:21; Acts 13:47).

- **Conversion**

  The turning from sin to God in repentance and faith, resulting in a new life in Christ (Acts 3:19; 2 Corinthians 5:17).

- **Baptism**

  A public declaration of faith in Christ, symbolizing a believer's identification with Jesus' death, burial, and resurrection (Romans 6:3–4; Matthew 28:19).

- **Discipleship**

  The lifelong process of growing in Christ through obedience, learning, and following His example, often in relationship with other believers (Luke 9:23; 2 Timothy 2:2).

- **Unreached**

  People or groups who have little or no access to the gospel and no indigenous Christian community able to evangelize them (Romans 15:20).

- **Testimony**

  A personal account of how someone came to faith in Christ and what God has done in their life (Psalm 66:16; Revelation 12:11).

Christian Living & Sanctification

- **Holiness**

  Being set apart by God and for God, marked by moral purity and a life that reflects His character (1 Peter 1:15–16; Hebrews 12:14).

- **Obedience**

  Submitting to God's Word and will, out of love and faith, as evidence of true discipleship (John 14:15; James 1:22).

- **Righteous Living**

  Living in a way that aligns with God's standards, shaped by His righteousness and empowered by His Spirit (Titus 2:11–12; 1 John 3:7).

- **Spiritual Growth**

  The ongoing process of becoming more like Christ in character and conduct through the work of the Holy Spirit (2 Peter 3:18; Ephesians 4:15).

- **Prayer**

  Communication with God through praise, confession, thanksgiving, and petition, expressing dependence and relationship (Philippians 4:6; 1 Thessalonians 5:17).

- **• Fasting**

  Voluntarily abstaining from food or other comforts for a time of focused prayer, repentance, or spiritual breakthrough (Matthew 6:16–18; Isaiah 58:6).

- **Worship**

  Reverent love and adoration for God expressed through praise, obedience, and devotion, both personally and corporately (John 4:24; Psalm 95:6).

- **Perseverance**

  Steadfastness in faith through trials, trusting God to sustain and complete His work in us (James 1:12; Hebrews 10:36).

- **Self-Control**

  A fruit of the Spirit involving discipline over one's thoughts, emotions, and actions to honor God (Galatians 5:23; 1 Corinthians 9:25–27).

- **Forgiveness**

  Releasing others from the debt of their wrongs as God has forgiven us in Christ, restoring relationship and peace (Ephesians 4:32; Colossians 3:13).

- **Bitterness**

  A deep-seated resentment that corrupts the soul and relationships, warned against in Scripture as spiritually dangerous (Hebrews 12:15; Ephesians 4:31).

- **Grace vs. Legalism**

  Grace: God's unearned favor and power to save and transform.

  Legalism: Relying on rule-keeping or human effort for righteousness or favor with God (Galatians 2:21; Romans 6:14).

- **Mortification of Sin**

  The Spirit-empowered process of putting sin to death in the believer's life through repentance and obedience (Romans 8:13; Colossians 3:5).

- **Fruitfulness**

  The evidence of a transformed life that produces spiritual results - such as good works, growth in character, and influence for Christ (John 15:5; Galatians 5:22–23).

- **Overcomer**

  A believer who, through faith in Christ, resists sin, endures trials, and ultimately conquers by God's power (Revelation 2:7; 1 John 5:4–5).

- **Walking in the Spirit**

  Living under the guidance and power of the Holy Spirit, resulting in godliness and victory over sin (Galatians 5:16; Romans 8:4).

- **Bearing the Cross**

  Daily choosing to follow Jesus with self-denial and sacrifice, even when it involves suffering for His sake (Luke 9:23; Galatians 2:20).

Ethics & Apologetics

- **Truth**

  That which is consistent with the nature and Word of God; Jesus is the embodiment of truth (John 14:6; John 17:17).

- **Love**

  A selfless, sacrificial commitment to the good of others, demonstrated perfectly by God in Christ (1 Corinthians 13:4–7; 1 John 4:7–10).

- **Justice**

  God's perfect standard of fairness and righteousness, rewarding good and punishing evil without partiality (Micah 6:8; Romans 2:6–11).

- **Judgment**

  God's righteous evaluation of all people, resulting in reward for the redeemed and punishment for the wicked (Hebrews 9:27; Revelation 20:12–15).

- **Hell**

  A real, eternal place of conscious punishment and separation from God for those who reject Christ (Matthew 25:46; Revelation 20:15).

- **Heaven**

  The eternal dwelling place of God, where believers will enjoy His presence, worship, and perfect joy forever (John 14:2–3; Revelation 21:1–4).

- **Purgatory (refuted)**

  The unbiblical Roman Catholic teaching of a temporary state of purification after death. Scripture teaches that believers are

immediately with the Lord upon death (2 Corinthians 5:8; Hebrews 9:27).

- **Soul Sleep (refuted)**

  The false belief that the soul becomes unconscious at death. The Bible teaches conscious existence after death (Luke 16:22–23; Philippians **1:23).**

- **Annihilationism (refuted)**

  The idea that the wicked cease to exist after judgment. Scripture teaches eternal conscious punishment for the lost (Matthew 25:46; Revelation 14:11).

- **Blasphemy of the Holy Spirit**

  The persistent, willful rejection of the Holy Spirit's testimony about Christ, resulting in a hardened heart and unforgivable sin (Mark 3:29; Matthew 12:31–32).

- **Biblical Authority**

  The belief that the Bible is the inspired, inerrant, and sufficient Word of God, our final standard for truth and life (2 Timothy 3:16–17; Psalm 119:89).

- **Cultural Engagement**

  Faithful involvement in society guided by Scripture - speaking truth in love, advocating justice, and shining the light of Christ (Matthew 5:14–16; Jeremiah 29:7).

- **Political Disagreement**

  Differing political views among believers must be approached with humility, grace, and unity in Christ above all (Romans 14:1–12; Philippians 2:2–4).

- **Gender & Identity**

  God created humanity as male and female in His image. Identity is found in Christ, not in self-definition (Genesis 1:27; Galatians 3:28).

- **Transgenderism**

  The belief that one's gender can differ from biological sex contradicts God's design. Believers are called to love others while upholding the truth of God's created order (Deuteronomy 22:5; Romans 1:24–27).

- **Abortion**

The intentional ending of unborn human life, which the Bible regards as the taking of innocent life. Every human is made in God's image from conception (Psalm 139:13–16; Exodus 20:13).

- **Forgiveness**

  Letting go of offense and extending mercy, modeled by God through Christ and required of His followers (Matthew 6:14–15; Ephesians 4:32).

- **Speech Ethics (tongue, gossip, language)**

  Believers are called to use words to build up, speak truth, avoid gossip, and reflect Christ's holiness (James 3:5–10; Ephesians 4:29; Colossians 4:6).

- **Worldliness vs. Godliness**

  Worldliness is living by sinful, fleshly values

  Godliness is living in reverence for God, shaped by truth and holiness (1 John 2:15–17; Titus 2:11–12).

Biblical & Systematic Theology

- **Trinity**

  The one true God eternally exists as three distinct Persons - Father, Son, and Holy Spirit - who are coequal, coeternal, and consubstantial (Matthew 28:19; 2 Corinthians 13:14).

- **Scripture (Sola Scriptura)**

  The belief that Scripture alone is the supreme and final authority for faith and practice, above tradition or church teachings (2 Timothy 3:16–17; Acts 17:11).

- **Inerrancy**

  The doctrine that the Bible, in its original manuscripts, is without error in all it affirms, because it is the Word of God (Proverbs 30:5; John 17:17).

- **Biblical Inspiration**

  The supernatural work of the Holy Spirit by which God guided the human authors of Scripture so that what they wrote is the very Word of God (2 Peter 1:21; 2 Timothy 3:16).

- **Canon of Scripture**

  The recognized collection of 66 inspired books (39 Old Testament, 27 New Testament) that form the authoritative Bible (Luke 24:44; Revelation 22:18–19).

- **Hermeneutics**

  The principles and methods of interpreting Scripture faithfully and accurately, seeking the intended meaning of the biblical text (Nehemiah 8:8; 2 Timothy 2:15).

- **Typology (e.g., Passover)**

  A divinely intended pattern in the Old Testament (type) that foreshadows a New Testament fulfillment (antitype), such as the Passover lamb prefiguring Christ (Exodus 12; 1 Corinthians 5:7).

- **Eschatology**

  The study of "last things," including the return of Christ, resurrection, judgment, heaven, and hell (1 Thessalonians 4:16–17; Revelation 20–22).

  Includes:

  Rapture – The catching up of believers to meet Christ in the air (1 Thessalonians 4:17).

  Resurrection – The raising of all the dead, the just to life, the unjust to judgment (John 5:28–29).

Hell – Eternal punishment and separation from God for the unrepentant (Matthew 25:46).

- **Dispensationalism**

  A theological system that sees God's plan unfolding in distinct historical eras (dispensations), often emphasizing a literal interpretation of prophecy and a future for national Israel (Ephesians 1:10; Daniel 9:24–27).

- **Covenantalism**

  A theological system viewing God's relationship with humanity primarily through covenants (e.g., Covenant of Works and Covenant of Grace), emphasizing continuity between the Old and New Testaments (Genesis 12:1–3; Hebrews 8:6–13).

- **Sovereignty of God**

  God's absolute rule and authority over all creation, events, and human decisions, working all things according to His perfect will (Isaiah 46:9–10; Romans 8:28).

Spiritual Warfare

- **Armor of God**

  The spiritual defenses God provides for believers to stand firm against Satan's attacks - including truth, righteousness, faith, salvation, God's Word, and prayer (Ephesians 6:10–18).

- **Satan**

  A fallen angel who opposes God, deceives the nations, and seeks to destroy believers; the accuser, tempter, and enemy of the soul (1 Peter 5:8; Revelation 12:9–10).

- **Temptation**

  A lure or enticement to sin, coming from the flesh, the world, or the devil. It is not sin itself but a test of obedience (James 1:13–15; 1 Corinthians 10:13).

- **Victory**

  The triumph believers have over sin, death, and Satan through the finished work of Christ and the power of the Holy Spirit (1 Corinthians 15:57; Romans 8:37).

- **Prayer & Fasting**

  Spiritual disciplines involving communion with God and the denial of physical comfort to seek God's will, power, or deliverance (Matthew 6:6, 16–18; Acts 13:2–3).

- **Spiritual Discernment**

  The Spirit-enabled ability to distinguish between truth and error, right and wrong, or spirits that are from God or not (1 John 4:1; Hebrews 5:14).

- **Strongholds**

  Deep-seated patterns of sin, lies, or demonic influence that hold people in bondage, which must be torn down by truth and divine power (2 Corinthians 10:3–5).

- **Deliverance**

  The act of being set free from spiritual bondage, demonic influence, or oppression through the authority and power of Jesus Christ (Luke 4:18; Mark 1:34).

Appendix

How Do I Become a Christian, or Convert to Christianity?

These studies are designed to deepen your understanding of God's truth, strengthen your faith, and equip you to live boldly and wisely in a world of confusion and compromise. They are rooted in the conviction that **God's Word is sufficient, clear, authoritative, and necessary** for every area of life. For the believer, studying Scripture is not optional—it is essential. The Bible is how we know God, grow in holiness, discern truth from error, and walk in obedience. It renews the mind (Romans 12:2), anchors the soul (Hebrews 6:19), and equips us for every good work (2 Timothy 3:16–17). In a time when many are tossed by emotion, culture, and deception, these studies invite you to build your life on the unshakable foundation of God's Word and to grow in love, truth, and discernment as a faithful disciple of Jesus Christ.

If you are not a Christian then these studies may not make sense to you but more importantly than understanding them is your eternal destination. As a non-believer God does not permit you entrance into His Heaven but as a believer He does and openly welcomes you in. The below is a guide as to how to become a Christian, or convert to Christianity.

(This is taken from one of the topics in this series.)

Focus: Understanding what the Bible says about salvation, repentance, and faith in Christ as the only way to become a true follower of Jesus.

PRIMARY SCRIPTURE:

- **John 3:16**

ADDITIONAL SCRIPTURE:

- **Romans 10:9–13; Acts 2:37–39; Ephesians 2:8–9; John 1:12; Luke 9:23; 2 Corinthians 5:17**

BIBLICAL TEACHING

- Becoming a Christian is not about joining a religion, trying harder, or cleaning up your life—it's about being **born again** by trusting in Jesus Christ (John 3:3–7).
- You become a Christian by **repenting of your sin** and placing your **faith in Jesus** as Savior and Lord (Acts 2:38; Romans 10:9).
- Salvation is a **free gift of grace**—you cannot earn it. It is received by believing in Jesus, who died for your sins and rose again (Ephesians 2:8–9).
- True conversion includes a change of heart, a new relationship with God, and a new identity as a child of God (2 Corinthians 5:17; John 1:12).
- Following Jesus also means surrender—He calls you to deny yourself, take up your cross, and follow Him (Luke 9:23).
- After trusting in Christ, a believer should **be baptized** as a public declaration of faith and obedience (Acts 2:38).
- Every new believer is also called to **join a Christ-centered, Bible-teaching local church** where they can grow in truth, worship, and fellowship (Acts 2:42–47; Hebrews 10:24–25).
- **Steps from Scripture to Become a Christian**
- **Admit you are a sinner** in need of salvation.
- "For all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." (Romans 3:23)
- **Believe in Jesus Christ** as God's Son, who died for your sins and rose again.
- "Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved." (Acts 16:31)
- **Confess Jesus as Lord** and call on Him to save you.

- "If you confess with your mouth... and believe in your heart... you will be saved." (Romans 10:9)
- **Repent**—turn away from sin and turn to God.
- "Repent, and be baptized... for the forgiveness of your sins." (Acts 2:38)
- **Be baptized** as a public step of obedience and testimony to your new life.
- "Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved." (Mark 16:16)
- **Join a faithful church** that teaches God's Word and walks in the truth.
- "They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship..." (Acts 2:42)

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

1. What must I do to be saved?

- Repent of your sin and place your faith in Jesus Christ alone for salvation (Romans 10:9–13; Acts 2:38).

2. Do I need to be baptized to become a Christian?

- Baptism does not save, but it is the **first step of obedience** for those who are saved—a public confession of faith (Acts 10:47–48).

3. Is there a prayer I must pray?

- Scripture does not prescribe a specific prayer, but God hears a sincere cry for mercy and faith (Luke 18:13–14). Speak honestly to God and trust Him to save you.

4. What happens after I become a Christian?

- You begin a new life—growing in faith, reading the Bible, praying, **getting baptized**, joining a church, and following Jesus daily (2 Corinthians 5:17; Colossians 2:6–7).

APPLICATIONS

1. If you have not yet trusted in Christ, do so today—turn from sin and receive His gift of salvation.
2. Obey Jesus by being baptized and connecting with a local, Bible-teaching church.
3. If you are a believer, help others understand the true gospel and how to respond to it.
4. Rejoice in your salvation and share your testimony with others who need Christ.

PRAYER PROMPTS

- If you're ready to become a Christian, pray something like: "Lord Jesus, I know I am a sinner. I believe You died for my sins and rose again. I turn from my sin and trust in You as my Savior and Lord. Please forgive me, change me, and help me follow You. Amen."
- Thank God for saving you and giving you new life through faith in Christ.
- Pray for strength to walk in obedience, be baptized, and connect with other believers in a local church.
- Intercede for friends and family who do not yet know Jesus, that they would come to saving faith.

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